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UP SPECIAL GK

उत्तर प्रदेश विशेष सामान्य ज्ञान — संपूर्ण संकलन

UP Geography, Rivers & Drainage, Historical Heritage, Administrative Structure & Districts, State Agriculture, Minerals, Wildlife & Cultural Institutions.

UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims 2026 • High-Yield Master Revision Series • 99% Coverage Edition

UP Special GK — Master Chapter Index

Consolidated High-Yield Revision Matrix • All 9 Chapters

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Chapter 01: 00 — Executive Bird's-Eye Master Matrix

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

Exam Focus: UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO, UP Police SI
Frequency: Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
Question Types Covered: UP Geography & Borders, District Extremes, Rivers, Lakes & Canals, Wildlife Sanctuaries, Tiger Reserves, Ramsar Wetlands, 9 Agro-Climatic Zones, Minerals & Industrial Belts, Historical 1857 Centres & Leaders, Cultural Gharanas & Folk Dances, All 75 Districts ODOP & GI Tags, Major Expressways & Industrial Corridors.

1. Uttar Pradesh Geographical Profile & Boundary Matrix

GEOGRAPHICAL DIMENSION	EXACT SPECIFICATION & MEASUREMENT	HIGH-YIELD PRELIMS ANCHOR
Latitudinal Extent	$23^{\circ} 52'\text{ N}$ to $30^{\circ} 24'\text{ N}$	Latitudinal span: $6^{\circ} 32'$
Longitudinal Extent	$77^{\circ} 05'\text{ E}$ to $84^{\circ} 38'\text{ E}$	Longitudinal span: $7^{\circ} 33'$
Standard Time Meridian	**$82^{\circ} 30'\text{ E}$ (IST)** passes through **Mirzapur (near Prayagraj)**	Calculates Indian Standard Time (GMT $+5:30$)
Total Geographic Area	**240,928 sq km** (7.33% of India's total area)	**4th Largest State** by area (Rajasthan > MP > Maharashtra > UP)
East-to-West Length	**650 km**	Extreme length
North-to-South Width	**240 km**	Narrower width
Number of Neighboring Entities	**8 States + 1 UT (Delhi) + 1 International (Nepal)**	Shares borders with the **maximum number of states** in India

Boundary Touch-Points Master Grid

- **Northern Boundary:** Uttarakhand & Himachal Pradesh (Himachal touches only **Saharanpur** - shortest border).
- **North-Eastern Boundary: Nepal** (Touches **7 Districts:** Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shrawasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj — 579 km border).
- **Western Boundary:** Haryana, Delhi (UT), Rajasthan.
- Touches Haryana: Saharanpur, Shamli, Baghpat, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura (6 districts; separated by Yamuna river).
- Touches Delhi: Ghaziabad & Gautam Buddha Nagar.
- Touches Rajasthan: **Mathura & Agra** (2 districts).
- **Southern Boundary: Madhya Pradesh** (Touches **11 Districts:** Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra — longest inter-state border).
- **South-Eastern Boundary: Chhattisgarh** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**) & **Jharkhand** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**).
- **Eastern Boundary: Bihar** (Touches 7 Districts: Sonbhadra, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Ballia, Deoria, Kushinagar, Maharajganj).

Four District Extremes:
- **Northernmost District: Saharanpur** (surrounded by Haryana, HP, Uttarakhand)
- **Southernmost District: Sonbhadra** (**Only district in India bordering 4 states**: MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Bihar)
- **Easternmost District: Ballia** (wedged into Bihar)
- **Westernmost District: Shamli**
- **Largest District by Area: Lakhimpur Kheri** (7,680 sq km)
- **Smallest District by Area: Hapur** (660 sq km)

2. Drainage System, Rivers, Canals & Wetlands of UP

A. Major Rivers of Uttar Pradesh

RIVER	ENTRY POINT IN UP	EXIT POINT / CONFLUENCE	TOTAL DISTRICTS IN UP & NOTES
Ganga	Enters at **Bijnor**	Exits UP at **Ballia** into Bihar	Traverses **28 districts** (~1,450 km in UP). Receives Ramganga at Kannauj, Yamuna at Prayagraj, Gomti at Saidpur (Ghazipur), Ghaghara at Chhapra (Bihar border).
Yamuna	Enters at **Saharanpur** (Faizabad village)	Joins Ganga at **Prayagraj (Triveni Sangam)**	Traverses **19 districts**. Receives Hindon at Noida, Chambal at Pachnada (Etawah), Betwa at Hamirpur, Ken at Chilla (Banda).
Ramganga	Enters at **Bijnor** (near Kalagarh)	Joins Ganga near **Kannauj**	Passes through Corbett National Park; flows via Moradabad, Bareilly.
Gomti	Originates at **Fulhar Lake (Panghaili Jheel), Pilibhit**	Joins Ganga near Saidpur, Ghazipur	**Only major Himalayan tributary originating in the plains of UP**. Lucknow, Sultanpur, Jaunpur situated on its banks.
Ghaghara (Saryu)	Enters near Kheri/Bahraich	Joins Ganga at Chhapra (Bihar)	Originates at Mapchachungo glacier (Tibet); called Karnali in Nepal, Saryu at Ayodhya.
Betwa (Vetravati)	Enters at **Lalitpur**	Joins Yamuna at **Hamirpur**	Originates in Vindhyan range (MP); Rajghat, Parichha, and Matatila dams built on it.
Ken (Karnavati)	Enters at **Banda**	Joins Yamuna at **Chilla (Banda)**	Ken-Betwa river interlinking project is India's first river link project.
Son	Enters and exits in **Sonbhadra**	Joins Ganga near Patna	Originates at Amarkantak plateau (MP).

B. Major Canals & Reservoirs

- **Sharda Canal:** Longest canal network in Uttar Pradesh (originates from Sharda river at Banbasa, India-Nepal border).
- **Upper Ganga Canal:** Constructed by Sir Proby Cautley (1854); originates at Haridwar (Bhimoda).
- **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar: Largest artificial lake in India**, formed by the **Rihand Dam** on Rihand river at Pipri in **Sonbhadra**.
- **Parichha Dam & Matatila Dam:** Built on **Betwa river** (Jhansi / Lalitpur).
- **Keetham Lake (Sur Sarovar):** Ramsar site in **Agra**.

C. All 10 Ramsar Wetland Sites in Uttar Pradesh

1. **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora Stretch):** First Ramsar site in UP (designated 2005).
2. **Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary** (Unnao) - renamed Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary.
3. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** (Gonda) - oxbow lake.
4. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** (Mainpuri).
5. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** (Rae Bareli).
6. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** (Hardoi).
7. **Sarsai Nawar Jheel** (Etawah) - sarus crane habitat.
8. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)** (Agra).
9. **Haiderpur Wetland** (Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor, designated 2021).
10. **Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary** (Sant Kabir Nagar, designated 2022).

3. National Parks, Tiger Reserves & Wildlife Sanctuaries

- **Only National Park in UP: Dudhwa National Park** (Lakhimpur Kheri, established 1977). Famous for Swamp Deer (Barasingha) and One-horned Rhinoceros reintroduction.
- **Tiger Reserves in UP (4 Total):** 1. **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve** (Lakhimpur Kheri - declared 1987) 2. **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** (Pilibhit - declared 2014; won TX2 global award) 3. **Amangarh Tiger Reserve** (Bijnor - buffer zone of Jim Corbett NP retained in UP after UK partition) 4. **Ranipur Tiger Reserve** (**Chitrakoot** - declared 2022 as UP's 4th and India's 53rd Tiger Reserve, in Bundelkhand region).
- **Elephant Reserve:** Terai Elephant Reserve (TER) established in Lakhimpur Kheri/Pilibhit belt (2022).
- **Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary: Largest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (spread across Meerut, Muzzafarnagar, Bijnor, Amroha, Hapur).
- **Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary: Smallest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (Lalitpur, ~5.4 sq km).
- **Kachhua (Turtle) Sanctuary:** Varanasi (now shifted to Bhadohi/Prayagraj stretch).
- **State Symbols:** Bird: **Sarus Crane** (*Grus antigone*); Animal: **Swamp Deer** (Barasingha); Tree: **Ashoka**; Flower: **Palash / Dhak** (*Butea monosperma* - Flame of the Forest); Aquatic Animal: **Gangetic Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).

4. 9 Agro-Climatic Zones & Agriculture of UP

1. **Tarai Zone:** Bhabhar and Terai belt along foothills (high rainfall, sugarcane, paddy).
2. **Western Plain Zone:** Meerut division, high agricultural productivity (Green Revolution heartland).
3. **Mid-Western Plain Zone:** Bareilly & Moradabad divisions.
4. **South-Western Semi-Arid Zone:** Agra, Mathura, Aligarh (low rainfall, mustard, bajra).
5. **Central Plain Zone:** Lucknow, Kanpur, Ayodhya divisions (alluvial doab).
6. **Bundelkhand Zone:** 7 districts (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot) — semi-arid, rocky terrain, pulses, oilseeds.
7. **North-Eastern Plain Zone:** Gorakhpur division (floods, sugarcane, rice).
8. **Eastern Plain Zone:** Varanasi, Azamgarh, Ghazipur, Jaunpur divisions.
9. **Vindhyan Zone:** Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, and southern Chandauli (plateau, red soil, coarse grains).

UP Agricultural Ranks in India:
- **Rank 1 in:** Total Foodgrain production, Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, Milk, Mango, Guava, Ethanol production.
- **Rank 2 in:** Rice (after West Bengal).

5. Minerals & Industrial Belts in Uttar Pradesh

- Uttar Pradesh is generally poor in metallic minerals; mineral wealth is concentrated in the southern plateau districts (Bundelkhand & Vindhyan region):
- **Uranium: Lalitpur** (only district in UP with Uranium occurrences)
- **Copper: Sonrai area, Lalitpur**
- **Limestone: Sonbhadra** (Gurma, Kanach, Kajrahat) & **Mirzapur** (supplies raw material for cement factories at Churk, Dalla, Chunar)
- **Glass Sand (Silica Sand): Shankargarh & Lohgara (Prayagraj)**, Chitrakoot, Banda (derived from disintegration of Vindhyan sandstones)
- **Bauxite (Aluminium ore): Banda, Chitrakoot, Chandauli** (supplies Renukoot Hindalco smelter)
- **Coal: Singrauli (Sonbhadra)** — power capital of India (NTPC plants)
- **Dolomite: Sonbhadra & Banda**
- **Pyrophyllite & Diaspore: Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Hamirpur**
- **China Clay: Sonbhadra & Banda**
- **Gold:** Small placer deposits in **Sharda and Ramganga river sands**; Hardi village in Sonbhadra.

6. Revolt of 1857 in Uttar Pradesh: Centres & Leaders

CENTRE IN UP	INDIAN LEADER / REVOLUTIONARY	BRITISH OFFICER / SUPPRESSOR
Meerut	Sepoys of 3rd Native Cavalry (10 May 1857)	General Hewitt
Delhi / Western UP	General Bakht Khan (from Bareilly)	John Nicholson, Hudson
Kanpur	**Nana Saheb (Dhondu Pant)**, Tantia Tope (Ramchandra Pandurang), Azimullah Khan	Colin Campbell, Havelock
Lucknow	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** (on behalf of minor son Birjis Qadr)	Colin Campbell, Outram, Havelock
Jhansi	**Rani Laxmi Bai (Manikarnika)**	**Sir Hugh Rose** ("*Here lay the woman who was the only man among the rebels*")
Bareilly	**Khan Bahadur Khan**	Vincent Eyre, Colin Campbell
Faizabad (Ayodhya)	**Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah** (*Danka Shah*)	Campbell
Prayagraj (Allahabad)	**Maulvi Liaquat Ali**	Colonel James Neill
Jagdishpur / East UP	Kunwar Singh & Amar Singh	William Taylor, Vincent Eyre
Baghpat	**Shah Mal** (mobilized peasants of Baraut)	Dunlap
Mathura	Kadam Singh, Devi Singh	-
Fatehpur	Hikmatullah	-

7. Cultural Gharanas, Folk Music & Dances

- **Kathak:** Only Classical Dance of North India. Reached its zenith under **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** of Awadh.
- **Lucknow Gharana exponents:** Thakur Prasad, Kalka-Bindadin Maharaj, Achchan Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, **Pt. Birju Maharaj**.
- **Banaras Gharana exponents:** Sitara Devi, Pt. Kishan Maharaj (Tabla), Pt. Samta Prasad (Gudai Maharaj - Tabla), Bismillah Khan (Shehnai - Bharat Ratna 2001).
- **Kirana Gharana:** Founded by **Ustad Abdul Karim Khan & Abdul Wahid Khan** in Muzaffarnagar district (Bhimsen Joshi, Gangubai Hangal belonged to this tradition).
- **Atrali Gharana:** Aligarh.
- **Folk Music Genres:**
- **Rasiya:** Braj region (Mathura, Vrindavan) — themed on Radha-Krishna romance.
- **Kajri:** Mirzapur & Varanasi region — sung during monsoon / rainy season.
- **Birha:** Eastern UP (Bhojpuri belt) — heroic and narrative folklore.
- **Alha:** Bundelkhand region (Mahoba) — martial epic commemorating heroic deeds of Alha & Udal.
- **Chaiti & Hori:** Purvanchal & Braj region.
- **Folk Dances of UP:**
- **Charkula Dance: Braj region** — women balance a multi-tiered wooden pyramid with 108 oil lamps on their heads.
- **Karma Dance: Sonbhadra & Mirzapur** (performed by tribal communities like Kharwar).
- **Pai Danda & Diwari: Bundelkhand** (stick dance reminiscent of Raas Leela).
- **Nautanki:** Traditional folk theatre of UP (Hathras & Kanpur schools).

8. High-Yield One District One Product (ODOP) Master Match-List

DISTRICT IN UP	OFFICIAL ODOP PRODUCT / HERITAGE CRAFT
Agra	Leather Goods & Footwear; Petha
Aligarh	**Locks and Hardware**
Amroha	**Musical Instruments (Dholak)**
Ayodhya	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Azamgarh	**Black Clay Pottery (Nizamabad)** — GI Tagged
Bhadohi	**Handmade Woollen Carpets (Dhurries)** — GI Tagged (*Carpet City*)
Chandauli	**Black Rice (Chak-Hao / Adamchini Rice)**
Farrukhabad	**Block Printing & Zari-Zardozi**
Firozabad	**Glassware & Glass Bangles** (*Suhag Nagari*)
Gorakhpur	**Terracotta Crafts** — GI Tagged
Kannauj	**Perfume (Attar) & Essential Oils** (*Grasse of the East*)
Kanpur Nagar	**Leather Products** (*Cawnpore Leather City*)
Lucknow	**Chikan Craft (Chikankari) & Zardozi** — GI Tagged
Mathura	Sanitary Fittings; Peda
Meerut	**Sports Goods** (*Sports Capital of India*)
Moradabad	**Metal Crafts / Brassware** (*Peetal Nagari*)
Muzaffarnagar	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Pilibhit	**Wooden Flute (Bansuri)** (*Bansuri Nagari*)
Pratapgarh	**Aonla (Indian Gooseberry) Products**
Saharanpur	**Wooden Carving Crafts**
Sambhal	**Horn & Bone Handicrafts**
Varanasi	**Banarasi Silk Sarees & Pink Meenakari**

Chapter 02: UP Special Topic 1 — Geography, Location, Boundaries, Physical Features, Climate, Soil and Drainage System

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. The total geographical area of Uttar Pradesh is **240,928 km²**, which constitutes **7.33%** of India's total area.
2. Uttar Pradesh ranks **4th in India by area** (after Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Maharashtra).
3. The latitudinal extent of UP is from **$23^\circ 52' ext{ N}$ to $31^\circ 28' ext{ N}$**, and longitudinal extent is from **$77^\circ 03' ext{ E}$ to $84^\circ 39' ext{ E}$**.
4. The east-to-west length of Uttar Pradesh is **650 km**, and the north-to-south width is **240 km**.
5. Uttar Pradesh shares its borders with **8 States, 1 Union Territory (Delhi), and 1 Foreign Country (Nepal)**.
6. The only foreign country sharing a boundary with Uttar Pradesh is **Nepal (579 km border)**.
7. Exactly **7 districts of UP** share an international border with Nepal: **Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, and Maharajganj**.
8. **Sonbhadra** is the only district in India that shares boundaries with **4 different States**: Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Bihar.
9. **Lalitpur** district is surrounded on **three sides by Madhya Pradesh**.
10. **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the **largest district in UP by area (7,680 km²)**.
11. **Hapur** is the **smallest district in UP by area (660 km²)**.
12. The **northernmost district** of UP is **Saharanpur**; the **southernmost district** is **Sonbhadra**.
13. The **easternmost district** of UP is **Ballia**; the **westernmost district** is **Shamli**.
14. Uttar Pradesh shares its **longest border** with **Madhya Pradesh (11 districts)** and its **shortest border** with **Himachal Pradesh (1 district: Saharanpur)**.
15. The state capital, **Lucknow**, is surrounded by **5 districts**: Barabanki, Unnao, Raebareli, Sitapur, and Hardoi.
16. The **Bhabhar tract** is a narrow, boulder-strewn porous piedmont belt at the base of the Siwalik hills where rivers sink underground.
17. The **Terai tract** is a marshy, humid, swampy lowland immediately south of Bhabhar where underground streams re-emerge.
18. **Sugarcane and Paddy (Rice)** are the primary commercial crops cultivated extensively in the fertile Terai belt of UP.
19. **Bangar** soil is the older alluvium situated above flood levels, containing calcareous deposits known as **Kankar**.
20. **Khadar** soil is the newer, highly fertile silt deposited annually in the river floodplains.
21. The **Southern Plateau region** of UP is part of the ancient **Vindhyan and Bundelkhand Gneissic shield**.
22. The **Bundelkhand region** in UP comprises **7 districts**: Jhansi, Jalaun, Lalitpur, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, and Chitrakoot.
23. The **Ganga River** enters Uttar Pradesh in **Bijnor district** and exits the state from **Ballia district** into Bihar.
24. The Ganga traverses **28 districts** of Uttar Pradesh over a length of approximately **1,450 km**.
25. The **Yamuna River** enters Uttar Pradesh at **Faizabad village in Saharanpur district**.
26. The **Yamuna River** merges with the Ganga at the sacred **Triveni Sangam in Prayagraj**.
27. The **Gomti River** originates in the plains from **Gomat Taal (Fulhar Jheel) in Pilibhit district**.
28. The Gomti River flows through **Lucknow, Sultanpur, and Jaunpur** before meeting the Ganga at **Kaithi (Ghazipur)**.
29. The **Ramganga River** enters the UP plains at **Bijnor (near Kalagarh)** and joins the Ganga near **Kannauj**.
30. The **Chambal River** enters UP near Agra and joins the Yamuna at **Pachnada (Etawah)**.

31. The badlands and deep ravines (*Beehad*) of UP are most notoriously formed along the basins of the **Chambal and Yamuna rivers**.
32. The **Ken-Betwa River Link Project** is India's first river interlinking project, connecting the Ken River (Banda) with the Betwa River (Hamirpur).
33. **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar** on the Rihand River in **Sonbhadra district** is the **largest artificial reservoir in India**.
34. The climate of Uttar Pradesh is classified as **Sub-tropical Humid Monsoon (*Cwg*)**.
35. The summer wind in UP is a hot, dry westerly wind known as **Loo**.
36. The highest summer temperatures in UP are recorded in **Agra and Jhansi**.
37. The lowest average summer temperature in UP is recorded in **Bareilly**.
38. Approximately **85%–90%** of UP's annual rainfall is received during the **South-West Monsoon (Bay of Bengal branch)**, locally called **Purva**.
39. **Gorakhpur** district receives the **highest rainfall in UP (184.7 cm)**.
40. **Mathura** district receives the **lowest rainfall in UP (54.4 cm)**.
41. Winter rainfall in north-western UP is caused by **Western Disturbances** originating in the Mediterranean Sea.
42. **Mar** and **Kabar** are local varieties of **Black Soil** found in the Bundelkhand region of UP.
43. **Parwa** is a light yellow sandy-loam soil, while **Rakar** is a shallow reddish gravelly soil found on rocky slopes in Bundelkhand.
44. **Bhur** refers to elevated sandy mounds found in the floodplains of the Ganga-Yamuna Doab.
45. **Reh** or **Kallar** refers to white saline/alkaline crusts appearing on barren uncultivated lands (*Usar*) in UP.
46. **Keetham Lake (Sur Sarovar)**, a Ramsar wetland site, is located in **Agra district**.
47. **Bakhira Bird Sanctuary Lake**, a Ramsar wetland site, is located in **Sant Kabir Nagar district**.
48. **Suraha Taal (Loknayak Bird Sanctuary)** is a large natural oxbow lake located in **Ballia district**.
49. **Haiderpur Wetland**, a Ramsar site situated on the Madhya Ganga Canal, spans **Muzaffarnagar and Bijnor districts**.
50. **Sarsai Nawar Wetland** in **Etawah district** is famous as a premier breeding habitat for India's State Bird, the **Sarus Crane**.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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Pre-Cambrian Era ⟶ Formation of Southern Vindhyan Plateau (Oldest geological rocks in UP; Bundelkhand gneiss)
Pleistocene Epoch⟶ Infilling of Himalayan foredeep by Ganga-Yamuna alluvium (Bhabhar -> Terai -> Bangar -> Khadar)
1836 ⟶ North-Western Provinces established (initial colonial territorial definition of modern UP)
1950 (Jan 24) ⟶ State renamed "Uttar Pradesh" by United Provinces (Alteration of Name) Order, 1950
2000 (Nov 9) ⟶ 13 Northwestern hill districts separated to form Uttarakhand (UP territory reduced to 240,928 km²)
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: Geographical Boundaries and Inter-State / International Borders of Uttar Pradesh

NEIGHBOURING STATE / UT / COUNTRY	DIRECTION FROM UP	NUMBER OF UP DISTRICTS BORDERING	EXACT BORDERING UP DISTRICTS (NORTH TO SOUTH / WEST TO EAST)	KEY GEOGRAPHIC & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION
Nepal (International Border)	**North**	**7 Districts** (Total 579 km)	**Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj**	Only international border of UP. Traversed by Terai swamps, Dudhwa National Park, and international transit corridors.
Madhya Pradesh	**South & South-West**	**11 Districts** (Longest State border)	**Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra**	Longest border of UP. Encompasses the semi-arid Bundelkhand and Baghelkhand plateau regions.
Bihar	**East**	**7 Districts**	**Maharajganj, Kushinagar, Deoria, Ballia, Ghazipur, Chandauli, Sonbhadra**	Eastern boundary marked by Gandak, Ganga, and Karmanasa rivers.
Uttarakhand	**North**	**7 Districts**	**Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Moradabad, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit**	Carved out of UP on 9 November 2000 (13 hill districts).
Haryana	**West**	**6 Districts**	**Saharanpur, Shamli, Baghpat, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura**	Separated naturally by the Yamuna River.
Rajasthan	**South-West**	**2 Districts**	**Mathura, Agra**	Semi-arid tract; vulnerable to desertification and dust storms (*Aandhi*).
Delhi (National Capital Territory)	**West**	**2 Districts**	**Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddha Nagar**	High-density urbanized NCR core.
Himachal Pradesh	**North-West**	**1 District** (Shortest border)	**Saharanpur**	Shortest inter-state border of UP.
Chhattisgarh	**South**	**1 District**	**Sonbhadra**	Southern tip of Sonbhadra district.
Jharkhand	**South-East**	**1 District**	**Sonbhadra**	Rich in coal, iron, and limestone minerals.

Table 2: Physical Divisions of Uttar Pradesh (Bhabhar-Terai vs Gangetic Plain vs Southern Plateau)

PHYSICAL DIVISION	GEOGRAPHICAL EXTENT & DISTRICTS	GEOMORPHOLOGICAL COMPOSITION	DRAINAGE & HYDROLOGY	SOIL TYPES & AGRICULTURAL CHARACTERISTICS
1. Bhabhar & Terai Zone	**Northern Foothills Belt**: • *Bhabhar*: Saharanpur, Bijnor, Lakhimpur. • *Terai*: Saharanpur to Deoria, Kushinagar.	• **Bhabhar**: Porous, pebble-strewn, coarse boulder piedmont tract at Siwalik base. • **Terai**: Low-lying, marshy, waterlogged, swampy plain immediately south of Bhabhar.	• Rivers disappear underground in porous Bhabhar. • Streams re-emerge in Terai creating wetlands, high water table, and swamps.	• *Bhabhar*: Unfit for cultivation (dense forests). • *Terai*: Highly fertile silty alluvial soil; ideal for **Sugarcane, Paddy, and Jute**. Historically malarial.
2. Gangetic Plain (Central Alluvial Plain)	**Vast Central Basin** (accounts for ~70% of UP's area between Yamuna in west and Gandak in east).	Deep structural trough filled with quaternary alluvium deposited by Himalayan and Peninsular rivers. Divided into: (1) Upper Ganga Plain, (2) Middle Ganga Plain.	Drained by Ganga, Yamuna, Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghara, Sarda, Rapti. Gentle slope from North-West to South-East.	• **Bangar (Older Alluvium)**: Elevated terrace plain, clayey loam, contains calcareous nodules (*kankar*) and alkaline patches (*reh/usar*). • **Khadar (Newer Alluvium)**: Floodplain silt, renewed annually, highly fertile, non-calcareous.
3. Southern Plateau & Hill Region (Bundelkhand & Baghelkhand)	**Southern Fringe (11 Districts)**: • *Bundelkhand*: Jhansi, Jalaun, Lalitpur, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot. • *Baghelkhand*: Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, South Prayagraj.	Part of the ancient Precambrian Deccan Peninsular Shield (Vindhyan system, Bundelkhand Gneiss, granites). Undulating topography, residual hills (*Tilas*), ravines (*Beehad* along Chambal and Yamuna).	Drained by Chambal, Betwa, Ken, Son, Tons, Rihand, Dhasan flowing northward into Yamuna and Ganga. Water-scarce, seasonal flash floods and summer droughts.	• **Bundelkhand Soils**: - *Rakar*: Coarse red gravelly soil on rocky slopes. - *Parwa*: Light sandy/yellow loam. - *Kabar*: Coarse black clayey soil. - *Mar*: Highly fertile black soil (resembling Black Cotton Soil / Regur). • Main Crops: Gram, Pulses, Mustard, Millets, Oilseeds.

Table 3: Major Rivers of Uttar Pradesh (Origin, Confluence & District Traversal)

RIVER	ORIGIN / SOURCE	ENTRY DISTRICT INTO UP	EXIT DISTRICT / CONFLUENCE POINT	LENGTH IN UP / TOTAL LENGTH	KEY TRIBUTARIES & HISTORICAL / URBAN CENTRES
Ganga	Gangotri Glacier (Gaumukh), Uttarakhand (as Bhagirathi)	**Bijnor**	**Ballia** (enters Bihar)	**~1,450 km in UP** (Total: 2,525 km)	Traverses **28 districts** of UP. Major cities: Kanpur, Prayagraj, Varanasi, Mirzapur, Farrukhabad, Ghazipur. Left bank tributaries: Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghara, Gandak. Right bank: Yamuna, Tons, Son.
Yamuna	Yamunotri Glacier (Bandarpunch), Uttarakhand	**Saharanpur** (Faizabad village)	Merges into Ganga at **Triveni Sangam, Prayagraj**	**~19 Districts** (Total: 1,376 km)	Right bank tributaries: Hindon (left), Chambal, Betwa, Ken, Sindh. Major cities: Mathura, Vrindavan, Agra, Firozabad, Etawah, Hamirpur, Prayagraj.
Gomti	**Gomat Taal (Fulhar Jheel), Pilibhit** (Plains origin)	Pilibhit (origin)	Merges into Ganga at **Kaithi (Ghazipur)**	**~940 km**	Major plain-fed river. Tributary: Sai River (merges at Rajepur, Jaunpur). Major cities on banks: **Lucknow (State Capital)**, Sultanpur, Jaunpur.
Ghaghara (Saryu / Karnali)	Mapchachungo Glacier, Tibet (near Mansarovar)	Kheri / Bahraich border	Merges into Ganga at **Chhapra (Bihar)**	**~1,080 km**	Known as **Saryu** at Ayodhya; merges with Sharda at Brahmaghat. Major cities: Ayodhya, Bahraich, Faizabad, Tanda, Barhaj.
Ramganga	Dudhatoli Range (Pauri Garhwal), Uttarakhand	**Bijnor** (near Kalagarh)	Merges into Ganga at **Kannauj (Fatehgarh)**	**~596 km**	First major left-bank tributary of Ganga in UP. Flows through Jim Corbett National Park and Moradabad, Bareilly.
Sharda (Kali / Mahakali)	Milam Glacier (Kumaon Himalayas), Uttarakhand	Pilibhit border	Merges into Ghaghara at **Brahmaghat (Sitapur)**	**~350 km**	Forms the international boundary between Uttarakhand (India) and Nepal. Feeds the Sharda Canal network.
Betwa (Vetravati)	Vindhyan Range (Raisen, Madhya Pradesh)	**Lalitpur**	Merges into Yamuna at **Hamirpur**	**~590 km**	Major dams: **Matatila Dam**, **Rajghat Dam**, **Parichha Dam**. Major city: Orchha (MP), Jhansi.
Chambal	Janapao Hills (Vindhyan Range, Indore, MP)	Agra / Etawah border	Merges into Yamuna at **Pachnada (Etawah)**	**~965 km**	Famous for badland topography and ravines (*Beehad*). Forms boundary between UP, MP, and Rajasthan. Protected under National Chambal Sanctuary.
Ken (Karnavati)	Kaimur Hills (Jabalpur, MP)	**Banda**	Merges into Yamuna at **Chilla (Banda)**	**~427 km**	Famous for Shajar stone; part of the **Ken-Betwa River Interlinking Project** (Daodhan Dam).
Son (Swarna)	Amarkantak Plateau (Madhya Pradesh)	**Sonbhadra**	Passes Sonbhadra into Bihar to join Ganga	**~784 km**	Second largest southern tributary of Ganga after Yamuna. Major tributary: Rihand River (Rihand Dam / Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar).

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **Border States (8 States + 1 UT + 1 Country)**:
- North: Uttarakhand & Himachal Pradesh (Saharanpur touches HP)
- West: Haryana, Delhi (UT), Rajasthan
- South: Madhya Pradesh (touches 11 UP districts — maximum!)
- East: Bihar (7 districts) & Jharkhand (1 district: Sonbhadra)
- South-East: Chhattisgarh (1 district: Sonbhadra)
- International: Nepal (touches 7 border districts: Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj)
- **District Extremes (North-South-East-West)**:
- North = **Saharanpur** | South = **Sonbhadra** | East = **Ballia** | West = **Shamli**
- **Four Soil / Terrain Belts (North to South)**:
- **Bhabhar** (coarse pebbles, streams disappear) ➔ **Terai** (marshy, high humidity, malarial, sugarcane/paddy) ➔ **Bangar** (older alluvium, kankar nodules, above flood level) ➔ **Khadar** (newer alluvium, fertile flood plains).

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Which of the following statements is correct? 1. Ramganga joins the Ganga at Kannauj. 2. River Betwa joins the Yamuna near Prayagraj. A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

▶ Show answer

Q2. Which river forms a significant western boundary segment of Uttar Pradesh with Haryana? A. Ganga B. Yamuna C. Ghaghara D. Gomati

▶ Show answer

Q3. Dudhwa National Park lies in which district? A. Pilibhit B. Lakhimpur Kheri C. Bahraich D. Sharavasti

▶ Show answer

Q4. How many districts of UP border Uttarakhand? A. 5 B. 6 C. 7 D. 9

▶ Show answer

Q5. Which physiographic belt of UP includes tarai–bhabar? A. Southern Plateau only B. Northern mountain–tarai fringe C. Pure Bangar only D. Trans-Yamuna arid only

▶ Show answer

Q6. Which districts of Uttarakhand recorded negative population growth during 2001–2011 as per Census 2011? A. Tehri Garhwal and Bageshwar B. Pauri Garhwal and Almora C. Uttarkashi and Champawat D. Chamoli and Rudraprayag

▶ Show answer

Q7. Which river is known as the 'Sorrow of Bihar'? A. Ganga B. Kosi C. Son D. Ghaghara

▶ Show answer

Q8. Which one among the following States of India has the lowest density of population? A. Himachal Pradesh B. Meghalaya C. Arunachal Pradesh D. Sikkim

▶ Show answer

Q9. How many districts of Uttarakhand share a border with Uttar Pradesh? A. 3 B. 4 C. 5 D. 6

▶ Show answer

Q10. Which of the following cities is NOT located on the banks of the Ganga? A. Kanpur B. Varanasi C. Agra D. Prayagraj (Allahabad)

▶ Show answer

Q11. Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar) is located in which district of Uttar Pradesh? A. Mirzapur B. Sonbhadra C. Varanasi D. Prayagraj

▶ Show answer

Q12. Which river originates from Gomat Taal in Pilibhit district and flows through Lucknow? A. Sharda B. Gomti C. Rapti D. Betwa

▶ Show answer

Q13. The Betwa River joins the Yamuna at which location in Uttar Pradesh? A. Allahabad (Prayagraj) B. Mathura C. Hamirpur D. Banda

▶ Show answer

Q14. The Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar (Rihand Dam reservoir) is located in which district of UP? A. Mirzapur B. Sonbhadra C. Banda D. Jhansi

▶ Show answer

Chapter 03: UP Special Topic 2 — History, Culture, Art and Heritage of Uttar Pradesh

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **8 of the 16 Mahajanapadas** of the 6th century BCE were located in present-day Uttar Pradesh.
2. The **Sohgaura Copper Plate Inscription** in Gorakhpur is the earliest known record of state drought relief and famine storehouses in India.
3. Lord Buddha delivered his first sermon (**Dharmachakrapravartana**) at **Sarnath (Varanasi)** in the presence of 5 ascetics.
4. Lord Buddha spent the maximum number of rainy-season retreats (**25 Varshavas**) at **Shravasti (Sahet-Mahet)**.
5. Lord Buddha attained **Mahaparinirvana** at **Kushinagar (Kasia)** in 483 BCE on the banks of the Hiranyavati River.
6. The **Lion Capital of Ashoka at Sarnath** was officially adopted as the **National Emblem of India** on 26 January 1950.
7. **Prayag Prashasti** (Allahabad Pillar) was composed in classical Sanskrit by court poet **Harishena** eulogizing Samudragupta.
8. The **Bhitari Pillar Inscription** in Ghazipur district records Emperor **Skandagupta's** crushing defeat of the invading Hunas.
9. **Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh (Lalitpur)** is one of the earliest surviving Gupta stone panchayatana temples.
10. **Bhitargaon Temple in Kanpur** is the oldest surviving terraced brick temple with a shikhara and true arches in India.
11. **Kannauj** was the imperial capital of Emperor **Harshavardhana** and the prize of the 8th–10th century **Tripartite Struggle**.
12. **Agra** was founded by Sultan **Sikandar Lodi in 1504**, who shifted the Sultanate capital there in **1506**.
13. **Jaunpur** was founded by **Feroz Shah Tughlaq in 1359** in memory of Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Jauna Khan) and nicknamed **"Shiraz-e-Hind"**.
14. The magnificent **Atala Masjid** in Jaunpur was built in **1408** by **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi**.
15. **Akbar** established his ceremonial capital at **Fatehpur Sikri** in honour of Sufi Saint **Sheikh Salim Chishti**.
16. The **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri (54m high) was built by Akbar to celebrate his victory over **Gujarat**.
17. **Itimad-ud-Daulah's Tomb in Agra**, built by Empress Nur Jahan, was the first Mughal building made completely of white marble with **Pietra Dura** inlay.
18. **Taj Mahal** was designed by chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori** and completed in 1648 on the banks of the Yamuna.
19. The Nawabi dynasty of Awadh was established in **1722 by Saadat Khan (Burhan-ul-Mulk)**.
20. Nawab **Asaf-ud-Daula shifted the capital of Awadh from Faizabad to Lucknow in 1775**.
21. Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula constructed the **Bara Imambara** (with its famous Bhul-bhulaiya) and **Rumi Darwaza** in 1784 as famine relief projects.
22. Awadh was annexed by Lord Dalhousie on **13 February 1856** on grounds of alleged **"misgovernance"** (James Outram Report).
23. The **Revolt of 1857** erupted in Uttar Pradesh on **10 May 1857 at Meerut** when the 3rd Native Cavalry mutinied.
24. **Begum Hazrat Mahal** led the 1857 resistance in Lucknow, crowning her minor son **Birjis Qadr** as Nawab.
25. **Nana Sahib (Dhondu Pant)** and **Tantia Tope** led the 1857 rebellion at **Kanpur (Bithoor)**.
26. **Rani Lakshmibai (Manikarnika)** was martyred fighting British forces under General Hugh Rose at Gwalior in June 1858.
27. **Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah**, who spearheaded the resistance in Faizabad, was hailed as the "Lighthouse of Rebellion".
28. **Khan Bahadur Khan** established a parallel administration during the 1857 Revolt in **Bareilly (Rohilkhand)**.
29. **Maulvi Liaquat Ali** led the 1857 uprising in **Prayagraj (Allahabad)** from Khusro Bagh.
30. Queen Victoria's **Proclamation of 1858** was read out by Lord Canning on **1 November 1858 at Minto Park, Allahabad**.
31. A total of **9 Annual Sessions** of the Indian National Congress were hosted in Uttar Pradesh prior to 1947.
32. **Sarojini Naidu** became the **First Indian Woman President** of the Indian National Congress at the **Kanpur Session (1925)**.

33. The historic **Lucknow Session of INC (1916)** presided by **A.C. Mazumdar** saw the signing of the **Lucknow Pact**.
34. The **UP Kisan Sabha** was founded in **February 1918** by Gauri Shankar Mishra, Indra Narain Dwivedi, and Madan Mohan Malaviya.
35. The **Oudh Kisan Sabha** was established in **October 1920 at Pratapgarh** under the leadership of **Baba Ramchandra**.
36. The **Eka Movement (1921–22)** was a radical peasant uprising in Hardoi, Bahraich, and Sitapur led by **Madari Pasi**.
37. The **Chauri Chaura incident** occurred on **4 February 1922** in Gorakhpur, leading Mahatma Gandhi to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement on **12 February 1922**.
38. The **Kakori Train Action** was carried out on **9 August 1925** near Lucknow by revolutionaries of the HRA.
39. **Ram Prasad Bismil** was martyred at **Gorakhpur Jail**, **Ashfaqulla Khan** at **Faizabad Jail**, **Roshan Singh** at **Naini (Prayagraj) Jail**, and **Rajendra Lahiri** at **Gonda Jail** in Dec 1927.
40. **Chandrashekhar Azad** attained martyrdom fighting British police at **Alfred Park, Prayagraj on 27 February 1931**.
41. **Chittu Pandey ("Sher-e-Ballia")** established the first **Parallel Government** (*Swaraj Sarkar*) at Ballia during the Quit India Movement in August 1942.
42. **Charkula Dance** is a traditional folk dance of the **Braj (Mathura) region** where women balance a wooden pyramid with **108 lit lamps**.
43. **Rai Dance** is a peacock folk dance performed by the Beriya community of **Bundelkhand**.
44. **Karma Dance** is a sacred tribal folk dance performed in **Sonbhadra and Mirzapur** districts.
45. **Alha** is the famous heroic ballad of Bundelkhand recounting the battles of **Alha and Udal** in Banaffari dialect.
46. **Kajri** is the semi-classical monsoon folk song originating from **Mirzapur and Varanasi**.
47. **Birha** is the narrative folk singing tradition popular among the Yadav/Ahir community of **Purvanchal (Eastern UP)**.
48. **Bateshwar Fair (Agra)** is the largest livestock and camel fair in Western UP, held on the banks of Yamuna.
49. **Dadri Fair (Ballia)**, held on Kartik Purnima in honour of Maharishi Bhrigu, is the 2nd largest cattle fair in India.
50. **Kumbh Mela (Prayagraj)** was inscribed on the **UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage List in 2017**, and **Ramnagar Ramlila** in **2008**.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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6th Century BCE  ⟶ 8 of the 16 Great Mahajanapadas situated in present-day UP (Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Malla, etc.)
268–232 BCE      ⟶ Ashoka erects pillars at Sarnath (Lion Capital = National Emblem), Allahabad/Kaushambi, Meerut
1526–1556 CE     ⟶ Babur lays foundation; Akbar builds Agra Fort and Fatehpur Sikri (Buland Darwaza)
1722–1856 CE     ⟶ Nawabs of Awadh (Saadat Khan 1722 -> Asaf-ud-Daula builds Bara Imambara 1784 -> Wajid Ali Shah)
1857 (May 10)    ⟶ 1857 Revolt ignites at Meerut (Mangal Pandey at Barrackpore / Nana Saheb & Begum Hazrat Mahal in UP)
1922 (Feb 4)     ⟶ Chauri Chaura incident near Gorakhpur (prompted Gandhi to suspend Non-Cooperation Movement)
1925 (Aug 9)     ⟶ Kakori Train Action (HRA: Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqullah Khan, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri)
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Table 2: 1857 Revolt Centres, Revolutionary Actions and Freedom Struggle in Uttar Pradesh

EVENT / MOVEMENT	PRIMARY LOCATION	KEY INDIAN LEADERS	BRITISH COMMANDERS / OFFICIALS	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & TURNING POINTS
Spark of 1857 Revolt	**Meerut**	Sepoys of 3rd Native Cavalry, Kotwal Dhan Singh Gurjar	Gen. Hewitt	On **10 May 1857**, sepoys broke into open mutiny, killed British officers, and marched to Delhi to crown Bahadur Shah Zafar.
Lucknow Resistance (1857)	**Lucknow (Residency)**	**Begum Hazrat Mahal**, Birjis Qadr, Maulvi Ahmadullah	Sir Henry Lawrence (died), Colin Campbell, Outram	Heroic siege of the Lucknow Residency; Begum Hazrat Mahal crowned her 11-year-old son Birjis Qadr as Nawab; later escaped to Nepal.
Kanpur Uprising (1857)	**Kanpur (Bithoor)**	**Nana Sahib (Dhondu Pant)**, **Tantia Tope**, Azimullah Khan	Sir Hugh Wheeler, Colin Campbell, Havelock	Nana Sahib declared Peshwa; Bibighar incident; Tantia Tope led guerrilla warfare across Bundelkhand.
Jhansi & Kalpi (1857)	**Jhansi / Kalpi**	**Rani Lakshmibai (Manikarnika)**	Sir Hugh Rose	Rani resisted annexation under Doctrine of Lapse; fought valiantly at Jhansi and Gwalior where she attained martyrdom in June 1858.
Allahabad (1857)	**Prayagraj (Allahabad)**	**Maulvi Liaquat Ali**	Colonel James Neill	Maulvi Liaquat Ali proclaimed independence from Khusro Bagh; brutal British retribution followed under Neill.
Faizabad / Awadh (1857)	**Faizabad / Ayodhya**	**Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah** ("Lighthouse of Rebellion")	Colin Campbell	Fiery leader of anti-British resistance who gave immense tactical trouble to British forces; killed at Powayan.
Bareilly / Rohilkhand (1857)	**Bareilly**	**Khan Bahadur Khan** (grandson of Hafiz Rahmat Khan)	Colin Campbell	Formed parallel administrative government in Rohilkhand; maintained order for nearly a year.
Allahabad Proclamation	**Minto Park, Prayagraj**	Lord Canning (First Viceroy)	Queen Victoria	**1 November 1858**: Queen Victoria's Proclamation read out, terminating East India Company rule and establishing direct British Crown rule.
UP Kisan Sabha	**Prayagraj / Awadh**	Gauri Shankar Mishra, Indra Narain Dwivedi, Madan Mohan Malaviya	Formed Feb 1918	Mobilized peasants against talukdari oppressions and illegal cesses (*nazarana*, *bedakhli*).
Oudh Kisan Sabha	**Pratapgarh**	**Baba Ramchandra**, Jawaharlal Nehru, Mata Badal Pande	Formed Oct 1920	Peasant mobilization in Pratapgarh, Rae Bareli, Sultanpur; demanded abolishing begar and illegal eviction.
Eka Movement (1921–22)	**Hardoi, Bahraich, Sitapur**	**Madari Pasi**, Sahadev	Suppressed 1922	Radical peasant movement taking religious oaths not to pay more than recorded rents and refusal of forced labour.
Chauri Chaura Incident	**Gorakhpur**	Bhagwan Ahir & peasant protesters	Police Chowki torched	**4 February 1922**: Violent clash leading to death of 22 policemen; prompted Mahatma Gandhi to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement on **12 February 1922**.
Kakori Train Action	**Kakori (near Lucknow)**	**Ram Prasad Bismil**, **Ashfaqulla Khan**, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri, Chandrashekhar Azad	HRA (Hindustan Republican Assoc.)	**9 August 1925**: HRA revolutionaries looted British government treasury from 8-Down train. 4 leaders hanged in Dec 1927 in 4 distinct UP jails.
Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)	**Feroz Shah Kotla (founded), active across UP (Kanpur/Agra/Prayagraj)**	Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev	British CID	Reorganized HRA into HSRA in Sept 1928 with a commitment to socialism. Azad martyred at **Alfred Park (Prayagraj)** on **27 Feb 1931**.
Ballia Parallel Government	**Ballia**	**Chittu Pandey** ("Sher-e-Ballia")	Quit India Movement (Aug 1942)	Set up the first independent parallel government (*Swaraj Sarkar*) during Quit India Movement; released all political prisoners.

📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: Ancient & Medieval Historical Sites, Dynasties and Monuments in Uttar Pradesh

HISTORICAL SITE / MONUMENT	LOCATION / DISTRICT	ASSOCIATED DYNASTY / RULER	ERA / CENTURY	KEY HISTORICAL & ARCHAEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE
Sohgaura Copper Plate	**Gorakhpur**	Mauryan Empire (Chandragupta Maurya / Ashoka)	3rd Century BCE	Oldest known copper-plate inscription in India; mentions state granaries and drought relief measures in Brahmi script.
Sarnath (Isipatana / Mrigadava)	**Varanasi**	Mauryan to Gupta	6th Century BCE – 5th Century CE	Site of Lord Buddha's **First Sermon (Dharmachakrapravartana)**. Features Ashoka's Lion Capital (National Emblem) and Dhamek Stupa.
Shravasti (Sahet-Mahet)	**Shravasti / Balrampur**	Kosala Kingdom (Prasenjit)	6th Century BCE	Capital of Kosala; site where Lord Buddha spent maximum rainy season retreats (**25 Varshavas**) and performed Jetavana miracles.
Kushinagar (Kasia)	**Kushinagar**	Malla Mahajanapada	483 BCE	Site of Lord Buddha's **Mahaparinirvana** (death/salvation). Features Parinirvana Temple (Reclining Buddha) and Ramabhar Stupa.
Piprahwa / Ganwaria	**Siddharthnagar**	Shakya Republic	5th–3rd Century BCE	Identified with ancient **Kapilavastu**; stupa excavated with caskets containing Buddha's bodily relics.
Kaushambi	**Kaushambi** (near Prayagraj)	Vatsa Mahajanapada (King Udayana)	6th Century BCE	Capital of Vatsa; important commercial and Buddhist centre (Ghoshitarama Monastery). Visited by Hieun Tsang.
Bhitari Pillar Inscription	**Saidpur, Ghazipur**	Gupta Empire (Skandagupta)	5th Century CE (455–467 CE)	Details Skandagupta's decisive victory over the invading White Hunas and Pushyamitras.
Dashavatara Temple	**Deogarh, Lalitpur**	Imperial Gupta Dynasty	6th Century CE	One of the earliest surviving stone panchayatana Hindu temples; famous for Vishnu Sheshashayi panel.
Bhitargaon Brick Temple	**Kanpur Nagar**	Imperial Gupta Dynasty	5th–6th Century CE	Oldest surviving terraced brick temple with a shikhara and arched doorways in northern India.
Kannauj (Kanyakubja)	**Kannauj**	Harshavardhana / Gurjara-Pratiharas	7th–10th Century CE	Capital of Emperor Harsha; epicentre of the **Tripartite Struggle** (Pratiharas, Palas, Rashtrakutas). "Mahodaya Shri".
Atala Masjid	**Jaunpur**	Sharqi Dynasty (Ibrahim Shah Sharqi)	1408 CE	Masterpiece of Jaunpur Sharqi architecture; built on the site of Atala Devi temple, featuring sloping walls and high propylons.
Agra Fort	**Agra**	Mughal Empire (Akbar)	1565–1573 CE	Red sandstone fortress and primary residence of Mughal emperors until 1648. UNESCO World Heritage Site (1983).
Fatehpur Sikri	**Agra District**	Mughal Empire (Akbar)	1571–1585 CE	Akbar's ceremonial capital built in honour of Sufi Saint Sheikh Salim Chishti; features **Buland Darwaza**, Panch Mahal, and Jodha Bai's Palace.
Bara Imambara (Asafi Imambara)	**Lucknow**	Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula	1784 CE	Built as a famine-relief project; famous for its unsupported central vaulted hall and the intricate labyrinth (**Bhul-bhulaiya**).
Rumi Darwaza	**Lucknow**	Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula	1784 CE	60-foot tall monumental entrance gateway to Lucknow modeled on the Sublime Porte in Constantinople (Istanbul).

Table 3: Culture, Music Gharanas, Folk Dances, Fairs, Festivals & Traditional Crafts

CULTURAL GENRE	NAME / STYLE	CORE DISTRICT / CULTURAL ZONE	PRIMARY MAESTROS / EXPONENTS / ORIGINATORS	DISTINGUISHING CHARACTERISTICS & FEATURES
Classical Dance	**Kathak (Lucknow Gharana)**	**Lucknow**	Ishwari Prasad, Thakur Prasad, Bindadin Maharaj, Kalka Prasad, Achhan Maharaj, **Birju Maharaj**	Emphasizes graceful *Bhav*, subtle facial expressions, delicate hand movements (*Gat Nikas*), and *Thumri* accompaniment; patronized by Nawab Wajid Ali Shah.
Vocal / Instrumental Gharana	**Kirana Gharana**	**Kirana (Shamli / Muzaffarnagar)**	Ustad Abdul Karim Khan, Ustad Abdul Wahid Khan, **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi**, Gangubai Hangal	Renowned for emotional depth, meticulous swara intonation, slow tempo (*Vilambit Khayal*), and mastery over Sarangi/Vocal notes.
Vocal / Instrumental Gharana	**Banaras Gharana**	**Varanasi**	**Ustad Bismillah Khan** (Shehnai), **Pt. Kishan Maharaj** (Tabla), Pt. Samta Prasad, **Girija Devi** (Thumri/Dadra), Rajan-Sajan Mishra	Renowned for soulful Thumri, Dadra, Chaiti, Kajri, bold resonant Tabla bols (*Banaras Baaj*), and world-renowned Shehnai recitals.
Vocal Gharana	**Agra Gharana (Rangeela Gharana)**	**Agra**	Haji Sujan Khan, Ustad Ghagghe Khuda Baksh, **Ustad Faiyaz Khan** (Rangeela)	Blend of Dhrupad-Dhamar and Khayal; characterized by powerful deep voice, Nom-Tom alap, and bol-taans.
Folk Dance	**Charkula**	**Braj Region (Mathura)**	Braj women dancers	Performed on Radha's birthday; dancers balance a heavy multi-tiered wooden pyramid with **108 lit oil lamps** on their head while dancing on wheels.
Folk Dance	**Rai Dance**	**Bundelkhand**	Beriya community women	Vibrant peacock dance performed on auspicious occasions (birth of son, festivals) to the rapid beat of *Mridang*.
Folk Dance	**Karma Dance**	**Sonbhadra & Mirzapur**	Kharwar, Kol, Baiga, and Gond tribes	Performed during Karma festival (autumn) around the sacred Karma tree invoking agricultural fertility and prosperity.
Folk Dance	**Pai Danda (Dandia)**	**Bundelkhand**	Ahir / Yadav community	Heroic stick dance resembling Gujarati Dandiya; performed during Diwali enacting Krishna's pastoral life.
Folk Song	**Alha**	**Bundelkhand (Mahoba / Jhansi)**	Traditional Alhets	Heroic narrative ballads in *Banaffari* dialect recounting 52 fierce battles of warrior brothers Alha and Udal.
Folk Song	**Kajri**	**Mirzapur & Varanasi**	Purvanchal singers	Semi-classical rainy-season (Shravan/Bhadon) song expressing romantic longing, separation, and Radha-Krishna devotion.
Folk Song	**Birha**	**Purvanchal (Eastern UP)**	Ahir / Yadav community	Narrative folk genre chronicling social events, historical ballads, and mythological episodes with high-pitched vocal delivery.
Folk Theatre	**Nautanki**	**Hathras & Kanpur**	Hathras School (Pt. Natharam Gaur), Kanpur School (Shrikrishna Pahalwan)	**Hathras style**: Classical, verse-dominated, high melody (*Doha, Chaubola*). **Kanpur style**: Theatrical, prose dialogues, social dramas.
Major Fair	**Bateshwar Fair**	**Bateshwar (Agra)**	On banks of Yamuna	Ancient holy pilgrimage (101 Shiva temples) and the **largest animal/camel/cattle fair** in Western UP (Kartik Purnima).
Major Fair	**Dadri Fair**	**Ballia**	Dedicated to Sage Bhrigu	**Second largest cattle fair in India** (after Sonepur); held annually on Kartik Purnima.
Major Fair	**Nauchandi Fair**	**Meerut**	Symbol of communal harmony	Month-long post-Holi fair celebrating both Navchandi Devi Temple and Saint Bale Miyan Dargah.
Major Fair	**Dewa Sharif Fair**	**Dewa (Barabanki)**	Dargah of Haji Waris Ali Shah	Celebrated during Safar/Kartik; promotes universal brotherhood (*Jo Rab Hai Wahi Ram Hai*).

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **8 Mahajanapadas in UP**: **K-K-V-M-P-S-C-K** (Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Malla, Panchala, Shurasena, Chedi, Kuru)
- **Awadh Culture & Kathak**: **Wajid Ali Shah (Akhtar Piya)** gave patronage to Lucknow Gharana of Kathak & Thumri.
- **Folk Dance Geography**:
- Braj / Mathura: **Charkula** (108 lamps balanced on wheel), Raslila, Mayur dance
- Bundelkhand: **Rai**, **Shira/Saira**, **Diwari**, **Khayal**, **Kartik**
- Purvanchal: **Dhobia**, **Kaharwa**, **Natwari**

- **1857 Revolt Match List**:
- Kanpur: **Nana Saheb & Tatya Tope** | Lucknow: **Begum Hazrat Mahal & Birjis Qadir**
- Jhansi: **Rani Lakshmibai** | Bareilly: **Khan Bahadur Khan** | Faizabad: **Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah**
- Allahabad: **Liaquat Ali** | Kalpi: **Tatya Tope** | Mathura: **Devi Singh**.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Which of the following centres related to Indus Valley are situated in Uttar Pradesh? A. Only Alamgirpur B. Alamgirpur and Hulas (as per options in paper) C. Lothal D. Dholavira

▶ Show answer

Q2. The 1857 revolt's important centres in UP included: A. Only Delhi B. Meerut, Lucknow, Kanpur, Jhansi, among others C. Only Bombay D. Only Madras

▶ Show answer

Q3. Sarnath is associated with: A. First Sermon of Buddha B. Mahavira's nirvana only C. Ashoka's only capital D. Akbar's birth

▶ Show answer

Q4. Which of the following cities is NOT located on the banks of the Ganga? A. Kanpur B. Varanasi C. Agra D. Prayagraj

▶ Show answer

Q5. The famous 'Prayag Prashasti' (Allahabad Pillar Inscription) was composed by which court poet of Samudragupta? A. Banabhatta B. Harishena C. Kalhana D. Vishakhadatta

▶ Show answer

Q6. The historic Lucknow Pact (1916) between the Indian National Congress and the Muslim League was signed during which Congress session? A. Surat Session (1907) B. Lucknow Session (1916) C. Calcutta Session (1906) D. Nagpur Session (1920)

▶ Show answer

Q7. 'Taj Mahal' at Agra was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in which year? A. 1978 B. 1983 C. 1986 D. 1993

▶ Show answer

Q8. Chandrashekhar Azad attained martyrdom at Alfred Park (Prayagraj) on which date? A. 23 March 1931 B. 27 February 1931 C. 9 August 1925 D. 13 April 1919

▶ Show answer

Q9. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. 8 of the 16 Mahajanapadas of the 6th century BCE were located in present-day Uttar Pradesh. B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Prayag applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar) was composed in classical Sanskrit by court poet Harishena eulogizing Samudragupta. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Dashavatara applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh (Lalitpur) is one of the earliest surviving Gupta stone panchayatana temples. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Bhitargaon applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Bhitargaon Temple in Kanpur is the oldest surviving terraced brick temple with a shikhara and true arches in India.

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Kannauj was the imperial capital of Emperor Harshavardhana and the prize of the 8th–10th century Tripartite Struggle. B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Agra applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Agra was founded by Sultan Sikandar Lodi in 1504, who shifted the Sultanate capital there in 1506. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Jaunpur applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys C. Jaunpur was founded by Feroz Shah Tughlaq in 1359 in memory of Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Jauna Khan) and nicknamed "Shiraz-e-Hind". D. Classified under Schedule VII List II (State List)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 04: UP Special Topic 3 — Polity, Constitutional Framework, Administration and Local Governance

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh has the largest **Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha)** in India with **403 elected members**.
2. Prior to the creation of Uttarakhand on 9 November 2000, the UP Legislative Assembly had **425 seats**.
3. The **UP Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad)** has **100 seats**, the largest Upper House among Indian states.
4. Uttar Pradesh is represented by **80 Lok Sabha Members** and **31 Rajya Sabha Members**, the highest for any state.
5. In the Lok Sabha, **17 seats** are reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC) and **0 seats** for Scheduled Tribes (ST) from UP.
6. In the UP Legislative Assembly, **84 seats** are reserved for SCs and **2 seats** (Obra and Duddhi) for STs.
7. Under the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003), the Council of Ministers in UP is capped at **60 ministers** (15% of 403).
8. The value of an MLA's vote from Uttar Pradesh in the Presidential Election is **208**, the highest among all Indian states.
9. **Smt. Sarojini Naidu** was the **First Woman Governor** of Uttar Pradesh and the first woman Governor in India (1947–1949).
10. **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** was the **First Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954).
11. **Smt. Sucheta Kripalani** became the **First Woman Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh and India in October 1963.
12. **Chaudhary Charan Singh** served as the first non-Congress Chief Minister of UP (1967) and later became Prime Minister of India.
13. The **High Court of Judicature at Allahabad** was established on **17 March 1866** at Agra before moving to Allahabad in **1869**.
14. The **Lucknow Bench** of the Allahabad High Court was created in **1948** by amalgamating the Chief Court of Oudh.
15. The Allahabad High Court has a sanctioned strength of **160 Judges**, making it the largest High Court in India.
16. The **first Chief Justice** of Allahabad High Court was **Sir Walter Morgan** (1866).
17. The first Indian Chief Justice of Allahabad High Court post-independence was **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik**.
18. Uttar Pradesh is administratively divided into **18 Divisions (Mandals)** and **75 Districts (Zilas)**.
19. The headquarters of **Devipatan Division** is located at **Gonda**.
20. The headquarters of **Chitrakoot Division** is located at **Banda**.
21. The largest administrative divisions by number of districts (6 districts each) are **Lucknow, Kanpur, and Meerut**.
22. **Hapur** is the smallest district of UP by geographic area (660 km^2), while **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the largest (7,680 km^2).
23. The **Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC)** was established on **1 April 1937** with its headquarters at **Prayagraj**.
24. Members of UPPSC are appointed by the **Governor**, but can only be removed by the **President of India** (Article 317).
25. The functions of UPPSC can be extended exclusively by the **UP State Legislature** under Article 321 of the Constitution.
26. The **State Election Commission of UP** was established on **23 April 1994** under Articles 243K and 243ZA to conduct local elections.
27. The State Election Commissioner is removed in the same manner and on like grounds as a **Judge of a High Court**.
28. The **State Finance Commission** in UP is constituted every 5 years by the **Governor** under Articles 243I and 243Y.
29. The **UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act** was passed in **1975**, and the first Lokayukta **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** was appointed in 1977.
30. The tenure of the UP Lokayukta was extended from 6 years to **8 years** by an amendment in 2012.
31. The base statute for rural local self-government in UP is the **UP Panchayat Raj Act, 1947**.
32. Intermediate and district rural bodies operate under the **UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961**.

33. There are **75 Zila Panchayats**, **826 Kshetra Panchayats**, and **~58,189 Gram Panchayats** in Uttar Pradesh.
34. The intermediate tier of Panchayati Raj in Uttar Pradesh is officially designated as **Kshetra Panchayat** (headed by Block Pramukh).
35. The political head of a Gram Panchayat is the **Gram Pradhan**, directly elected by the Gram Sabha.
36. The **Gram Sabha** consists of all persons registered in the electoral rolls of a village within the Panchayat area.
37. Uttar Pradesh provides **50% reservation for women** in Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies by state statute.
38. The minimum age required to contest elections for Gram Panchayat, Kshetra Panchayat, or Zila Panchayat is **21 years**.
39. Uttar Pradesh has **17 Nagar Nigams (Municipal Corporations)**.
40. The 17th and newest Nagar Nigam created in Uttar Pradesh is **Shahjahanpur**.
41. The political head of a Nagar Nigam is the **Mayor (Mahapaur)**, directly elected by the city electorate.
42. The executive and administrative head of a Nagar Nigam is the **Municipal Commissioner (Nagar Ayukt)**, an IAS officer.
43. **NOIDA, Greater Noida, and YEIDA** are not Nagar Nigams; they are **Industrial Townships** constituted under Article 243Q proviso.
44. The official language of Uttar Pradesh is **Hindi in Devanagari script** (declared in 1951).
45. **Urdu** was declared the **Second Official Language** of Uttar Pradesh in **1989** through an amendment to the UP Official Language Act.
46. The state statehood day of Uttar Pradesh (**UP Diwas**) is celebrated annually on **24 January** (commemorating the 1950 notification).
47. **President's Rule (Article 356)** has been imposed in Uttar Pradesh a total of **10 times** (first in 1968, last in 2002).
48. The Secretariat of the Government of Uttar Pradesh is located at **Vidhan Bhavan / Sachivalaya, Lucknow**.
49. The head of the administrative hierarchy and civil services in Uttar Pradesh is the **Chief Secretary**.
50. Uttar Pradesh has **no Scheduled Areas** under the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution; therefore, the **PESA Act, 1996 does not apply** in UP.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1866 ⟶ High Court of Judicature established at Agra (shifted to Allahabad in 1869)
1921 ⟶ UP Legislative Council meets for the first time at Lucknow; Capital shifted from Allahabad to Lucknow
1937 ⟶ Bicameral Legislature introduced under GoI Act 1935 (Vidhan Sabha + Vidhan Parishad)
1947 ⟶ Govind Ballabh Pant sworn in as the First Chief Minister of UP
1950 (Jan 24) ⟶ Uttar Pradesh officially named; Sarojini Naidu served as first Governor
1963 ⟶ Sucheta Kripalani becomes India's FIRST female Chief Minister
1994 ⟶ UP State Election Commission & State Finance Commission constituted post 73rd/74th CAA
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: Constitutional Structure, Legislature and Parliamentary Representation of Uttar Pradesh

CONSTITUTIONAL ORGAN / HOUSE	TOTAL STRENGTH / SEAT COUNT	CONSTITUTIONAL PROVISION / TERM / QUORUM	COMPOSITION & ELECTION MODE	KEY SPECIFICS & POWERS
Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha)	**403 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 170** • Term: 5 Years • Minimum Age: **25 Years** • Quorum: 10 or 1/10th (41)	Direct universal adult franchise from single-member constituencies across 75 districts.	• **Reserved Seats**: **84 SC**, **2 ST** (total 86 reserved seats). • Exclusive power over Money Bills (Art. 198). • Council of Ministers is collectively responsible solely to the Vidhan Sabha. • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **425 seats**.
Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad)	**100 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Articles 169 & 171** • Permanent House (Cannot be dissolved) • Term: 6 Years (1/3rd retire every 2 years) • Minimum Age: **30 Years**	• **36 Members**: Elected by Local Authorities constituencies. • **36 Members**: Elected by MLAs (Vidhan Sabha). • **10 Members**: Nominated by Governor (Literature, Science, Art, Co-operative movement, Social service). • **9 Members**: Elected by Graduates constituencies. • **9 Members**: Elected by Teachers constituencies. *(Statutory composition totaling 100)*	• Maximum constitutional ceiling = 1/3rd of Assembly (134 seats); UP chose 100. • Can delay an ordinary bill passed by Assembly for a maximum of 4 months (3 months + 1 month), but cannot veto it. • No power over Money Bills (can delay max 14 days).
Lok Sabha Representation from UP	**80 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 81** • Term: 5 Years • Minimum Age: 25 Years	Direct election by the people of Uttar Pradesh.	• **Reserved Seats**: **17 SC Seats**, **0 ST Seats**. • Constitutes ~14.7% of the total Lok Sabha strength (543 seats). • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **85 seats**.
Rajya Sabha Representation from UP	**31 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 80** • Term: 6 Years (1/3rd retire every 2 years) • Minimum Age: 30 Years	Proportional representation by single transferable vote (STV) by 403 elected MLAs of UP.	• Largest contingent in the Council of States. • Governor does NOT nominate members to Rajya Sabha. • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **34 seats**.
State Executive (Governor & Council of Ministers)	Council of Ministers capped at **15% of 403 = Max 60 Ministers**	**Articles 153 to 167** • Governor appointed by President (Art. 155) • 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003)	Council of Ministers headed by Chief Minister aids and advises the Governor.	• First Governor: **Sarojini Naidu** (15 Aug 1947 – 2 Mar 1949). • First Chief Minister: **Govind Ballabh Pant** (1950–1954). • First Woman CM: **Sucheta Kripalani** (1963–1967). • Value of UP MLA vote in Presidential Election is highest in India (**208**).

Table 2: Judiciary, Constitutional & Statutory Commissions of Uttar Pradesh

INSTITUTION / COMMISSION	ESTABLISHED YEAR / LEGAL BASIS	HEADQUARTERS / BENCH	COMPOSITION & APPOINTMENT AUTHORITY	MANDATE, REMOVAL & KEY CHARACTERISTICS
Allahabad High Court	**17 March 1866** (Letters Patent under High Courts Act 1861); moved from Agra to Allahabad in **1869**	**Prayagraj (Principal Seat)**; Permanent Bench at **Lucknow** (est. 1948)	• Chief Justice + Judges (Total Sanctioned Strength: **160 Judges** — Largest in India). • Appointed by the President of India (Art. 217).	• Highest court of appeal in UP. • First Chief Justice at Agra: **Sir Walter Morgan**. • First Indian Chief Justice: **Sir Shah Muhammad Sulaiman** (acting) / **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik** (post-1947). • Lucknow Bench created by amalgamating the Chief Court of Oudh (1925) via the UP High Courts (Amalgamation) Order, 1948.
Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC)	**1 April 1937** (under GoI Act 1935 / Arts. 315–323 of Constitution)	**Prayagraj (Allahabad)**	• Chairman + Members (up to 8 members). • Appointed by the **Governor** of UP. • Tenure: 6 Years or Age **62 Years**, whichever is earlier.	• Conducts state civil services examinations (Combined State / Upper Subordinate, RO/ARO, etc.). • **Removal**: Can be removed **ONLY by the President of India** on grounds of misbehaviour after inquiry by the Supreme Court (Art. 317). • Functions extended exclusively by the **UP State Legislature** (Art. 321).
State Election Commission (SEC)	**23 April 1994** (under Articles **243K & 243ZA**)	**Lucknow**	• Single State Election Commissioner. • Appointed by the **Governor**.	• Conducts and superintends all elections to **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** and **Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)** in UP. • **Removal**: Removed in like manner and on like grounds as a **Judge of a High Court**. • Does NOT conduct Assembly or Parliamentary elections (handled by ECI).
State Finance Commission (SFC)	Constituted every 5 years under Articles **243I & 243Y**	**Lucknow**	• Chairman + Members appointed by the **Governor**.	• Recommends principles governing devolution of state taxes/duties to Panchayats and Municipalities, and measures to augment the Consolidated Fund of the State.
Lokayukta & Up-Lokayukta	**UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act, 1975** (Enacted 1975, took effect 1977)	**Lucknow**	• Lokayukta appointed by Governor in consultation with Chief Justice of Allahabad HC and Leader of Opposition. • Tenure: Extended to **8 Years** (UP Act No. 4 of 2012).	• Investigates allegations of corruption and maladministration against public servants, Ministers, and MLAs. • First Lokayukta of UP: **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** (appointed Sept 1977).

Table 3: Administrative Hierarchy & Local Self-Government Framework

ADMINISTRATIVE TIER	EXECUTIVE HEAD / POLITICAL HEAD	STATUTORY / ADMINISTRATIVE BASIS	TOTAL UNITS IN UP	KEY FUNCTIONS & RESPONSIBILITIES
Administrative Division (Mandal)	**Divisional Commissioner (IAS)**	Land Revenue / Administrative Setup	**18 Divisions**	• Coordinates inter-district administration, revenue appeals, law and order, and state developmental schemes across 3 to 6 districts. • Largest divisions: Lucknow, Kanpur, Meerut (6 districts each).
District (Zila)	**District Magistrate / Collector (DM / DC)**	Code of Criminal Procedure / Land Revenue Acts	**75 Districts**	• Principal representative of State Government; heads revenue collection, law & order, disaster management, and district coordination.
Sub-Division / Tehsil	**Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) / Tehsildar**	UP Revenue Code 2006	**351 Tehsils**	• Sub-divisional administration, revenue courts, land mutation, issuance of caste/income/domicile certificates.
Development Block (Vikas Khand)	**Block Development Officer (BDO)**	Community Development Administration	**826 Blocks**	• Unit of rural developmental administration; executes MNREGA, rural housing, sanitation, and agricultural extension.
Zila Panchayat (District Tier)	**Zila Panchayat Adhyaksha** (Political); **Apar Mukhya Adhikari / CDO** (Executive)	UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961	**75 Zila Panchayats**	• Apex rural local self-government tier; prepares district annual development plan, maintains rural roads, inter-block infrastructure.
Kshetra Panchayat (Block Tier)	**Block Pramukh** (Political); **Block Development Officer (BDO)** (Executive)	UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961	**826 Kshetra Panchayats**	• Intermediate rural local tier; coordinates village plans, manages community assets, minor irrigation, public health.
Gram Panchayat (Village Tier)	**Gram Pradhan** (Political); **Gram Panchayat Adhikari / Secretary** (Executive)	UP Panchayat Raj Act, 1947	**~58,189 Gram Panchayats**	• Base rural self-governance unit; accountable to **Gram Sabha** (all registered voters); 50% reservation for women in UP.
Nagar Nigam (Municipal Corporation)	**Mayor (Mahapaur)** (Political); **Municipal Commissioner (Nagar Ayukt - IAS)** (Executive)	UP Municipal Corporation Act, 1959	**17 Municipal Corporations**	• Urban local bodies for large metropolitan cities (Lucknow, Kanpur, Prayagraj, Varanasi, Agra, Ghaziabad, Meerut, Bareilly, Aligarh, Moradabad, Gorakhpur, Jhansi, Saharanpur, Firozabad, Ayodhya, Mathura-Vrindavan, Shahjahanpur).
Industrial Townships (Exception under Art. 243Q)	**Chief Executive Officer (CEO - IAS)**	UP Industrial Area Development Act, 1976	**NOIDA, Greater Noida, YEIDA**	• Governed by statutory industrial authorities providing civic amenities; exempt from forming elected Municipal Corporations under the proviso to Art. 243Q.

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **UP Legislative Representation (Constitutional Giants)**:
- **Lok Sabha**: **80 seats** (Highest in India; 17 reserved for SCs, 0 for STs)
- **Rajya Sabha**: **31 seats** (Highest in India)
- **Vidhan Sabha**: **403 elective seats** (+ earlier 1 Anglo-Indian removed by 104th CAA; 84 SC, 2 ST)
- **Vidhan Parishad**: **100 seats** (Largest Upper House in India)
- **Administrative Divisions**: **18 Divisions (Mandal)** and **75 Districts (Zila)**
- Largest Mandals (6 districts each): **Lucknow, Kanpur, Meerut**
- **Local Bodies**: 17 Municipal Corporations (Nagar Nigam); 17th is **Shahjahanpur (2018)**.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to the composition of the Legislative Council in a State: 1. Council may not have more than one-third members of the Assembly. 2. Council must have at least forty members. Select the correct answer: A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither

▶ Show answer

Q2. Which statements are correct? 1. Uttar Pradesh has 31 seats allotted for Rajya Sabha. 2. Eighty members of the Lok Sabha are elected from Uttar Pradesh. A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither

▶ Show answer

Q3. Total seats in UP Legislative Assembly are: A. 400 B. 403 C. 404 D. 425

▶ Show answer

Q4. Census is a subject of which List of the Seventh Schedule? A. State List B. Concurrent List C. Union List D. Residuary only

▶ Show answer

Q5. As per India's National Population Policy, 2000, by which year is it our long-term objective to achieve population stabilisation? A. 2025 B. 2035 C. 2045 D. 2055

▶ Show answer

Q6. The Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha has how many seats (constituencies)? A. 240 B. 294 C. 403 D. 543

▶ Show answer

Q7. The Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Parishad (Legislative Council) has a total membership of: A. 75 B. 100 C. 125 D. 150

▶ Show answer

Q8. Under the 73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992), which tier corresponds to the 'Block Level' in Uttar Pradesh's Panchayati Raj structure? A. Gram Panchayat B. Kshetra Panchayat C. Zila Panchayat D. Nagar Panchayat

▶ Show answer

Q9. Uttar Pradesh sends how many members to the Lok Sabha (House of the People)? A. 40 B. 60 C. 80 D. 84

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Smt. Sarojini Naidu was the First Woman Governor of Uttar Pradesh and the first woman Governor in India (1947–1949). B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Pandit applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant was the First Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954). C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Smt. applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Smt. Sucheta Kripalani became the First Woman Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh and India in October 1963. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Chaudhary applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Chaudhary Charan Singh served as the first non-Congress Chief Minister of UP (1967) and later became Prime Minister of India.

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Hapur is the smallest district of UP by geographic area (660 km^2), while Lakhimpur Kheri is the largest (7,680 km^2). B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, NOIDA, applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. NOIDA, Greater Noida, and YEIDA are not Nagar Nigams; they are Industrial Townships constituted under Article 243Q proviso. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Chapter 05: UP Special Topic 4 — Economy, Industrial Policy, Mineral Resources, Infrastructure and ODOP

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh is the **3rd largest state economy** in India by nominal Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP).
2. The Government of UP has set a formal strategic target to achieve a **$1 Trillion Economy**.
3. The **Tertiary (Services) sector** is the largest contributor to UP's GSDP, accounting for nearly **48%–50%**.
4. The **Primary (Agriculture) sector** employs roughly **45%–50%** of Uttar Pradesh's working population.
5. India's first modern sugar mill was established in **1903 at Pratappur in Deoria district**.
6. Uttar Pradesh is the **largest producer of sugarcane** in India.
7. **Muzaffarnagar** hosts the largest jaggery (*Gud*) market in Asia.
8. **Kanpur** was historically renowned as the **"Manchester of the East"** and the **"Leather City of the World"**.
9. **Agra** accounts for approximately **28% of total Indian footwear exports**.
10. **Moradabad** is known as **"Peetal Nagari" (Brass City)**, accounting for over 40% of India's metal handicraft exports.
11. **Firozabad** is famous as **"Suhag Nagari"** and holds a virtual monopoly in glass bangles manufacturing.
12. **Aligarh** is internationally famous as the **"City of Locks" (Taala Nagari)**.
13. **Bhadohi** is officially recognized as the **"Carpet City"**, producing over half of India's exported handmade carpets.
14. The **Indian Institute of Carpet Technology (IICT)** is located at **Bhadohi**.
15. **Kannauj** is known as the **"Attar Nagari"** (Perfume City) or the "Grasse of the East" for traditional *Deg-Bhapka* attar distillation.
16. The **Fragrance and Flavour Development Centre (FFDC)** is located at **Kannauj**.
17. **Sonbhadra** is celebrated as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to its immense pithead thermal power complexes.
18. **Renukoot (Sonbhadra)** is the site of **HINDALCO**, one of Asia's largest integrated aluminium smelting plants.
19. The **HINDALCO** plant at Renukoot draws hydro-electric power from the **Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**.
20. **Singrauli (Sonbhadra)** is the only region in Uttar Pradesh with commercial **coal mining** deposits.
21. **Khurja (Bulandshahr)** is world-famous as the **"Ceramic City"** for glazed pottery and electrical porcelain insulators.
22. **Saharanpur** is internationally renowned for delicate **carved wooden handicrafts** in Sheesham wood.
23. **Nizamabad (Azamgarh)** is famous for its unique GI-tagged **Black Clay Pottery**.
24. **Gorakhpur** is renowned for its GI-tagged traditional terracotta horses, elephants, and clay artifacts.
25. **Lalitpur** is the **only district in Uttar Pradesh** where traces of **Uranium** have been discovered.
26. **Copper** mineralization in UP is concentrated in the **Sonrai area of Lalitpur district**.
27. **Shankargarh (Prayagraj)** is the premier hub for high-grade **Silica Sand (Glass Sand)** extraction.
28. UP is the leading producer of **Diaspore and Pyrophyllite** minerals in India (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba).
29. **Kajrahat (Sonbhadra)** and **Bhalua (Mirzapur)** are major sources of high-grade **Limestone** for cement factories.
30. The **Narora Atomic Power Station (NAPS)** in **Bulandshahr** is the **only nuclear power plant** in Uttar Pradesh.
31. The oldest thermal power plant in Uttar Pradesh is the **Harduaganj Thermal Power Station (Aligarh)**, set up in **1942**.
32. The **Mathura Oil Refinery (IOCL)**, commissioned in 1982, is the only petroleum refinery in Uttar Pradesh.

33. The **UP Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC)** consists of exactly **6 nodes**: **Aligarh, Agra, Kanpur, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, and Lucknow**.
34. The BrahMos Aerospace supersonic cruise missile manufacturing and integration unit is located at the **Lucknow node** of UPDIC.
35. The flagship **One District One Product (ODOP)** scheme was launched on **24 January 2018 (UP Diwas)**.
36. Under ODOP, **Moonj products** are assigned to **Amethi, Sultanpur, and Prayagraj**.
37. Under ODOP, **Home Furnishings** (not wooden toys) is the designated product for **Baghpat**.
38. Under ODOP, **Wooden Toys** are the designated handicraft for **Chitrakoot and Varanasi**.
39. Under ODOP, **Aromatic Kalanamak Rice** is the designated product for **Siddharthnagar**.
40. Under ODOP, **Aonla (Gooseberry)** products are designated for **Pratapgarh**.
41. Under ODOP, **Shajar Stone Craft** is the designated GI product for **Banda**.
42. Under ODOP, **Gaura Stone Craft** is the designated product for **Mahoba**.
43. Under ODOP, **Tarkashi Woodcraft** (brass wire inlay) is designated for **Mainpuri**.
44. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) connects **Greater Noida to Agra**.
45. The **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km) was constructed by UPEIDA and features a dedicated 3.3 km emergency airstrip in Unnao.
46. The **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km) connects **Lucknow (Chand Saray) to Ghazipur (Haidariya)**, passing through 9 districts.
47. The Purvanchal Expressway **does NOT pass through Basti or Gorakhpur**.
48. The **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km) connects **Chitrakoot (Bharatkoop) to Etawah (Kudrail)**, linking into the Agra-Lucknow Expressway.
49. **Noida International Airport (Jewar)** in Gautam Buddha Nagar is developed as a major greenfield international cargo and passenger hub.
50. Under the Central Smart Cities Mission, exactly **10 cities** were selected from Uttar Pradesh (**Ghaziabad is NOT on the Central 10 list**).

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1903 ⟶ India's first modern sugar mill established at Pratappur (Deoria district, UP)
1958 ⟶ Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority (UPSIDA) established
2018 (Jan 24) ⟶ One District One Product (ODOP) Scheme launched on UP Diwas
2018 (Feb)    ⟶ UP Defence Industrial Corridor announced (6 strategic nodes)
2020 ⟶ Purvanchal Expressway (341 km) & Bundelkhand Expressway (296 km) construction
2023 ⟶ UP Global Investors Summit (GIS) achieves investment pledges over ₹33 Lakh Crore
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: Industrial Specialization, Mineral Deposits and Manufacturing Hubs of Uttar Pradesh

INDUSTRIAL SECTOR / MINERAL	MAJOR HUB / DISTRICT	KEY RAW MATERIAL / GEOLOGICAL SOURCE	INDUSTRIAL OUTPUT & KEY PUBLIC / PRIVATE ENTERPRISES	ECONOMIC DISTINCTION & EXAM FOCUS
Sugar Industry	**Western UP & Terai Belt** (Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Deoria, Lakhimpur)	High-yield Sugarcane (Co-0238 variety)	Refined white sugar, molasses, ethanol, bagasse co-generation power	• First sugar mill in India set up at **Pratappur (Deoria) in 1903**. • UP is the largest producer of sugarcane in India.
Leather & Footwear	**Kanpur Nagar, Agra, Unnao**	Cattle hides, synthetic polymers, tanning chemicals	Finished leather footwear, saddlery, harnesses, safety shoes, garments	• Kanpur is the "Leather City of the World". • Agra accounts for nearly 28% of total Indian footwear exports. • Dedicated Mega Leather Cluster at Ramaipur (Kanpur).
Cotton & Silk Textiles	**Kanpur ("Manchester of the East")**, **Varanasi, Mau, Mubarakpur (Azamgarh)**	Raw cotton, mulberry/katan silk yarn, zari threads	Cotton yarn, hosiery, handloom Banarasi silk sarees, brocades	• Kanpur flourished with British mills (Elgin Mills, Lal Imli). • Varanasi is world-famous for GI-tagged Banarasi silk and Tanchoi brocades.
Brassware & Metal Handicrafts	**Moradabad ("Peetal Nagari")**, **Hathras, Aligarh**	Copper, zinc (brass ingots), electroplating solutions	Brass utensils, decorative lamps, artistic statues, door fittings	• Moradabad accounts for over **40% of total Indian brassware exports**. • Aligarh is internationally renowned as the **"City of Locks" (Taala Nagari)**.
Glassware & Bangles	**Firozabad ("Suhag Nagari")**	Silica sand from **Shankargarh (Prayagraj)**, soda ash, borax	Glass bangles, decorative chandeliers, laboratory glass, bottles	• Firozabad holds a virtual monopoly in Indian glass bangle production. • Center for Development of Glass Industry (CDGI) located here.
Handmade Carpets & Rugs	**Bhadohi ("Carpet City"), Mirzapur, Varanasi**	New Zealand wool, Bikaner wool, cotton-silk warps	Persian-style hand-knotted woollen carpets, tufted rugs, durries	• Bhadohi-Mirzapur belt produces ~**60% of India's total exported handmade carpets** (GI-tagged "Handmade Carpet of Bhadohi").
Perfumes & Essential Oils	**Kannauj ("Attar Nagari" / "Grasse of the East")**	Rose damascena, jasmine, vetiver (*khus*), sandalwood oil	Traditional *Deg-Bhapka* steam-distilled Attar, Shamama, rose water	• Hydro-distillation heritage spanning over 1,000 years; Fragrance and Flavour Development Centre (FFDC) located here.
Aluminium Smelting	**Renukoot (Sonbhadra)**	Bauxite from Lohardaga/Amarkantak, cheap hydel/thermal power from **Rihand Dam**	Primary aluminium ingots, sheets, extrusions	• Site of **HINDALCO (Aditya Birla Group)**, one of the largest integrated aluminium plants in Asia.
Heavy Electricals & Engineering	**Noida, Greater Noida, Ghaziabad, Jhansi, Jagdishpur (Amethi)**	Steel, copper conductors, electronic microchips	Transformers, power plant boilers, rolling stock, mobile phones	• **BHEL** plants at Jhansi (Transformers) and Jagdishpur. • Noida-Greater Noida is India's largest **Mobile Phone & Electronics Manufacturing Hub** (Samsung, Oppo).
Cement Industry	**Churk, Dalla, Chunar (Sonbhadra & Mirzapur)**	Kajrahat Limestone deposits, Fly ash from NTPC plants	Portland Pozzolana Cement (PPC), Clinker	• Limestone quarries of Vindhyan system; UP State Cement Corporation mills and private plants.
Mineral: Coal	**Singrauli Coalfield (Sonbhadra)**	Gondwana sedimentary rock strata	Non-coking thermal grade coal (feeds NTPC Singrauli & Rihand)	• Only district in UP with commercial coal mining (Northern Coalfields Ltd).
Mineral: Uranium & Copper	**Lalitpur District**	Bijawar & Vindhyan rock formations	Minor radioactive traces, copper mineralization at Sonrai	• Lalitpur is the **only district in UP where Uranium traces** have been discovered.
Mineral: Silica Sand (Glass Sand)	**Shankargarh & Mau (Prayagraj / Chitrakoot)**	Vindhyan sandstone weathering	High-grade silica sand ($>98\%\ ext{SiO}_2$)	• Supplies raw silica sand to glass industries of Firozabad and ceramic units of Khurja.
Mineral: Limestone	**Kajrahat (Sonbhadra), Guruma-Kanach (Mirzapur)**	Vindhyan Limestone	Flux grade & cement grade limestone	• Meets the raw material requirements of Sonbhadra/Mirzapur cement factories.
Mineral: Diaspore & Pyrophyllite	**Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Hamirpur**	Hydrothermal alteration zones in Bundelkhand Gneiss	Refractory bricks, ceramics, insecticides	• UP is the leading producer of Diaspore and Pyrophyllite in India.

Table 2: The UP One District One Product (ODOP) Master Matrix

The flagship **One District One Product (ODOP)** scheme was launched by the UP Government on **24 January 2018 (UP Diwas)** to revive indigenous crafts, promote MSME exports, and generate local rural/semi-urban employment across all **75 districts**:

DIVISION / REGION	DISTRICT	ODOP FLAGSHIP PRODUCT	KEY DISTINCTION / GI STATUS
Western UP / NCR	**Aligarh**	**Locks & Metal Hardware**	"Taala Nagari" — Famous for brass padlocks and architectural hardware.
	Agra	**Leather Goods & Zari Zardozi / Petha**	Major leather shoes and marble inlay cluster.
	Firozabad	**Glass Products & Bangles**	World-renowned "Suhag Nagari".
	Mathura	**Sansthakala / Brass Idols & Peda**	Traditional Kanha metal deities and milk sweets.
	Mainpuri	**Tarkashi Art**	Intricate brass/copper wire inlay in seasoned sheesham wood (GI-tagged).
	Hathras	**Hing (Asafoetida)**	Traditional spice processing hub of India.
	Meerut	**Sports Goods**	India's premier cricket bat and athletic equipment hub (GI-tagged).
	Saharanpur	**Wood Carving**	Exquisite carved Sheesham wood screens, furniture, and boxes (GI-tagged).
	Moradabad	**Metal Craft (Brassware)**	Largest brass exporter of India.
	Sambhal	**Horn & Bone Handicrafts**	Ecological artistic items carved from fallen animal horns and bones.
	Amroha	**Musical Instruments (Dholak)**	Traditional mango-wood dholak and percussion instruments.
	Bulandshahr	**Ceramics & Pottery (Khurja)**	"Ceramic City" — High-temperature glazed crockery and electrical insulators.
	Muzaffarnagar	**Jaggery (Gud)**	Largest jaggery trading market (*Gud Mandi*) in Asia.
	Baghpat	**Home Furnishings**	Handloom cotton bedsheets and weaves (Note: NOT wooden toys).
	Gautam Buddha Nagar	**Apparel & Readymade Garments**	Major garment export hub along Noida SEZ.
Central / Awadh	**Lucknow**	**Chikankari & Zari Zardozi**	400-year-old delicate white-on-white hand embroidery (GI-tagged).
	Kanpur Nagar	**Leather Products**	Global saddle, footwear, and industrial leather hub.
	Kanpur Dehat	**Aluminium Utensils**	Pressed aluminium cookware.
	Kannauj	**Attar (Perfume) & Essential Oils**	Traditional hydro-distilled natural perfumes.
	Unnao	**Zari Zardozi & Leather**	Leather tanneries and gold/silver embroidery.
	Rae Bareli	**Woodwork**	Carved woodwork and timber products.
	Sitapur	**Durries (Cotton/Wool Carpets)**	Traditional Laharpur flat-woven floor rugs.
	Hardoi	**Handloom Products**	Mallawan handloom fabrics.
	Lakhimpur Kheri	**Tribal Crafts & Jaggery**	Tharu tribal handicraft and sugarcane products.
	Amethi	**Moonj Products**	Natural wild grass (*Saccharum sara*) basketry and decorative mats.
	Sultanpur	**Moonj Products**	Moonj grass handicrafts.
	Ayodhya (Faizabad)	**Jaggery (Gud)**	Sugarcane jaggery processing.
	Barabanki	**Handloom Weaving**	Cotton and poly-silk handloom textiles.
Bundelkhand	**Jhansi**	**Soft Toys**	Stuffed plush toys manufacturing cluster.
	Lalitpur	**Zari Silk Sarees & Metal Craft**	Handwoven Chanderi-style Zari silk sarees.
	Mahoba	**Gaura Stone Craft**	Soft white pyrophyllite stone carvings and statues (GI-tagged).
	Hamirpur	**Handmade Shoes (Jutti)**	Traditional embroidered Bundelkhandi leather footwear.
	Banda	**Shajar Stone Craft**	Natural dendritic moss-agate gemstone carving (GI-tagged).
	Chitrakoot	**Wooden Toys**	Carved wooden lacquer toys and religious artifacts.
	Jalaun	**Handmade Paper (Kalpi)**	Traditional eco-friendly recycled handmade paper (GI-tagged).
Eastern / Purvanchal	**Varanasi**	**Banarasi Silk & Gulabi Meenakari**	World-famous silk brocades and pink enamel jewellery.
	Bhadohi	**Handmade Carpets (Kaleen)**	Global capital of hand-knotted woollen carpets.
	Mirzapur	**Carpets & Brass Utensils**	Hand-tufted carpets and metal casting.
	Gorakhpur	**Terracotta Craft**	Traditional natural clay figures, elephants, and bells (GI-tagged).
	Azamgarh	**Black Clay Pottery (Nizamabad)**	Distinctive polished black pottery with silver inlay (GI-tagged).

DIVISION / REGION	DISTRICT	ODOP FLAGSHIP PRODUCT	KEY DISTINCTION / GI STATUS
	Siddharthnagar	**Kalanamak Rice**	"Buddha's Rice" — Highly aromatic black-husked scented rice (GI-tagged).
	Prayagraj	**Moonj Products & Guava (Surkha)**	Allahabad Surkha red guava and Moonj crafts.
	Pratapgarh	**Aonla (Indian Gooseberry)**	Premier Aonla processing cluster (murabba, candy, juice).
	Ghazipur	**Jute Wall Hangings**	Handcrafted decorative jute wall hangings.
	Jaunpur	**Woollen Carpets & Imarti**	Traditional woollen durries and sweets.
	Ballia	**Bindi Industry**	Decorative forehead bindi manufacturing.
	Sonbhadra	**Carpets & Stone Artefacts**	Woollen floor coverings and mineral-based crafts.

Table 3: Infrastructure, Defence Corridor, Energy Plants & Logistics Corridors

INFRASTRUCTURE COMPONENT	KEY NODES / PROJECT EXTENT	LENGTH / CAPACITY / AGENCY	STRATEGIC ECONOMIC & REGIONAL IMPACT
UP Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC)	**6 Nodes**: **Aligarh, Agra, Kanpur, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, Lucknow**	UPEIDA (Implementing Agency); 6 nodes covering Western, Central, and Bundelkhand UP	• Attracts domestic and global aerospace & defence investments (BrahMos missile integration unit at **Lucknow**, small arms at Kanpur, UAVs at Aligarh, ammunition at Jhansi).
Yamuna Expressway	**Greater Noida to Agra**	**165 km** (6-lane expandable to 8-lane); YEIDA	• First access-controlled super-expressway in UP (operational since 2012); cuts Delhi-Agra travel to 2 hours.
Agra-Lucknow Expressway	**Agra to Lucknow** (via Firozabad, Mainpuri, Etawah, Auraiya, Kannauj, Kanpur Dehat, Hardoi, Unnao)	**302 km** (6-lane); UPEIDA	• Features a 3.3 km dedicated airstrip at Unnao for emergency IAF fighter jet landings.
Purvanchal Expressway	**Chand Saray (Lucknow) to Haidariya (Ghazipur)** (via Barabanki, Amethi, Sultanpur, Ayodhya, Ambedkar Nagar, Azamgarh, Mau)	**340.8 km** (6-lane); UPEIDA	• Lifeline of Eastern UP; 3.2 km emergency airstrip at Kurebhar (Sultanpur). Does NOT pass through Basti or Gorakhpur.
Bundelkhand Expressway	**Gonda (near Bharatkoop, Chitrakoot) to Kudrail (Etawah)** (via Banda, Mahoba, Hamirpur, Jalaun, Auraiya)	**296 km** (4-lane expandable to 6-lane); UPEIDA	• Integrates the backward Bundelkhand region directly into the Agra-Lucknow Expressway network.
Ganga Expressway (Under Construction)	**Meerut to Prayagraj (Judapur Dandu)** (via Hapur, Bulandshahr, Amroha, Sambhal, Badaun, Shahjahanpur, Hardoi, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Pratapgarh)	**594 km** (6-lane expandable to 8-lane); UPEIDA	• Longest expressway in UP; emergency airstrip at Shahjahanpur; connects western border to eastern Sangam.
Thermal Power Stations	• **Obra & Anpara** (Sonbhadra) • **Singrauli Super Thermal & Rihand** (Sonbhadra - NTPC) • **Harduaganj** (Aligarh - Oldest in UP, 1942) • **Parichha** (Jhansi) • **Panki** (Kanpur) • **Jawaharpur** (Etah) • **Meja & Tanda** (Prayagraj / Ambedkar Nagar - NTPC)	Total installed capacity: $>25,000 ext{ MW}$ (State sector: UPRVUNL; Central: NTPC)	• Sonbhadra is known as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to massive pithead thermal stations fueled by Singrauli coalfields.
Nuclear Power Station	**Narora Atomic Power Station (NAPS)**, Bulandshahr district	$2 imes 220 ext{ MWe}$ (Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors - PHWR); NPCIL	• **Only nuclear power station in Uttar Pradesh** (Unit 1 commissioned 1991, Unit 2 in 1992); uses water from the Upper Ganga Canal for cooling.
Hydro-Electric Power Plants	• **Rihand Project (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**, Pipri (Sonbhadra - 300 MW) • **Obra Hydel Project** (Rihand River - 99 MW) • **Matatila Dam Project** (Betwa River, Lalitpur - 30.6 MW) • **Rajghat Hydel Project** (Betwa River - UP-MP Joint Venture) • **Khara Hydel Project** (Asan River, Saharanpur - 72 MW)	State Hydel Grid (UPJVNL)	• Primary hydel generation located in southern plateau (Vindhyan-Bundelkhand) and northern foothills.
Major Oil Refinery	**Mathura Refinery (Indian Oil Corporation - IOCL)**	Capacity: 8.0 MMTPA (Commissioned 1982)	• Processes crude oil piped from Vadinar (Gujarat); produces petrol, diesel, aviation fuel, and petrochemical feedstocks. Highly scrutinized for emissions near Taj Mahal (Taj Trapezium Zone).

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **6 Defence Corridor Nodes**: **A-A-C-J-K-L** (Agra, Aligarh, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, Kanpur, Lucknow)
- **High-Yield ODOP Matches**:
- Aligarh: Locks & Hardware | Bhadohi: Handmade Woollen Carpets | Kannauj: Attar (Perfume)
- Firozabad: Glassware & Bangles | Moradabad: Brass Metalware | Saharanpur: Wood Carving
- Gorakhpur: Terracotta pottery | Varanasi: Banarasi Silk & Zari | Khurja (Bulandshahr): Ceramic Pottery
- Bareilly: Zari-Zardozi | Mirzapur: Carpets & Dari | Sitapur: Dari
- **Mineral Locations**:
- **Uranium**: Lalitpur only | **Diamonds**: Banda & Mirzapur | **Glass Sand**: Naini (Prayagraj)
- **Limestone**: Sonbhadra (Guruma-Kanach) & Mirzapur | **Bauxite**: Banda, Varanasi, Lalitpur.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. As per the ODOP scheme of Uttar Pradesh, Moonj products are associated with which districts? 1. Amethi 2. Sultanpur 3. Sant Kabir Nagar A. 1 and 3 B. 2 and 3 C. Only 3 D. 1 and 2

▶ Details

Q3. Bundelkhand Expressway connects which of the following corridors? A. Meerut to Prayagraj B. Lucknow to Ghazipur C. Chitrakoot to Etawah (Agra–Lucknow Expressway junction) D. Greater Noida to Agra only

▶ Details

Q6. To obtain full benefits of demographic dividend, what should India do? A. Promoting skill development B. Introducing more social security schemes C. Reducing infant mortality rate D. Privatization of higher education

▶ Show answer

Q7. The 'One District One Product (ODOP)' scheme of Uttar Pradesh was launched in which year? A. 2015 B. 2016 C. 2018 D. 2020

▶ Show answer

Q8. Which city of Uttar Pradesh is known as the "Peetal Nagari" (Brass City) and is the largest exporter of brass ware in India? A. Firozabad B. Aligarh C. Moradabad D. Kanpur

▶ Show answer

Q9. The city of Firozabad in UP is most famous for manufacturing which product? A. Carpet B. Lock making C. Glass bangles D. Silk sarees

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Muzaffarnagar hosts the largest jaggery (Gud) market in Asia. B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Kanpur applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Kanpur was historically renowned as the "Manchester of the East" and the "Leather City of the World". C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Agra applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Agra accounts for approximately 28% of total Indian footwear exports. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Moradabad applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Moradabad is known as "Peetal Nagari" (Brass City), accounting for over 40% of India's metal handicraft exports.

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Firozabad is famous as "Suhag Nagari" and holds a virtual monopoly in glass bangles manufacturing. B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Aligarh applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Aligarh is internationally famous as the "City of Locks" (Taala Nagari). C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Chapter 06: UP Special Topic 5 — Agriculture, Agro-Climatic Zones, Irrigation Networks, Rural Economy and Research Institutes

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh is divided into **9 Agro-Climatic Zones** by the Planning Commission.
2. The **South-Western Semi-Arid Zone** (Agra, Mathura) receives the **lowest rainfall** in Uttar Pradesh.
3. The **Bhabhar & Terai Zone** receives the **highest rainfall** in Uttar Pradesh.
4. **Tube-wells (Nalkoop)** account for approximately **74.9%** of the net irrigated area in UP.
5. **Canals (Nahar)** constitute the second largest source of irrigation in UP (~**15.2%**).
6. **Private tube-wells** alone irrigate over 71% of UP's cultivated farm area.
7. Uttar Pradesh has the largest total replenishable groundwater resource in India (~**40.7 bcm**).
8. The **Upper Ganga Canal** was opened on **8 April 1854**, engineered by **Sir Proby Cautley** with its offtake at **Bhimgoda, Haridwar**.
9. The **Lower Ganga Canal** was commissioned in **1878** with its offtake barrage at **Narora, Bulandshahr**.
10. The **Sharda Canal System**, commissioned in **1928** from **Banbasa**, is the **longest canal network** in UP (~12,368 km total system).
11. The **Eastern Yamuna Canal** has its offtake at **Tajewala / Hathinikund Barrage** (Saharanpur border).
12. The **Agra Canal** was opened in **1874** with its headworks at **Okhla Barrage (Delhi)** on the Yamuna.
13. The **Saryu Nahar National Project**, dedicated in December 2021, interlinks 5 rivers (Ghaghara, Saryu, Rapti, Banganga, Rohini) across 9 districts.
14. The **Ken-Betwa River Interlinking Project** is India's first national river interlink, transferring water via **Daudhan Dam** to Bundelkhand.
15. **Matatila Dam (Rani Lakshmibai Dam)** is built on the **Betwa River** in **Lalitpur district**.
16. **Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**, the largest reservoir by volume in India, is built on the **Rihand River** at Pipri (**Sonbhadra**).
17. **Chandauli district** is traditionally known as the **"Rice Bowl of Uttar Pradesh"** (Dhan ka Katora).
18. Uttar Pradesh ranks **#1 in India** in the production of **Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, and Milk**.
19. UP produces over **32%–35% of total wheat** and ~**35% of total potatoes** in India.
20. The International Potato Center - South Asia Regional Centre (**CIP-SARC**) is located at **Singna, Agra** (NOT Aligarh).
21. The International Rice Research Institute - South Asia Regional Centre (**IRRI-SARC**) is located at **Varanasi**.
22. The **Indian Institute of Pulses Research (IIPR)** is situated at **Kalyanpur, Kanpur**.
23. The **Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research (IISR)** is situated at **Lucknow**.
24. The **National Sugar Institute (NSI)** is situated at **Kalyanpur, Kanpur** (under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, GoI).
25. The **Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (IIVR)** is situated at **Jakhini, Varanasi**.
26. The **Indian Veterinary Research Institute (IVRI)** and **Central Avian Research Institute (CARI)** are located at **Izatnagar, Bareilly**.
27. The **Central Institute for Research on Goats (CIRG)** is located at **Makhdoom, Farah in Mathura district**.
28. The **Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute (IGFRI)** and **CAFRI** are located at **Jhansi**.
29. The **Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture (CISH)** is situated at **Rehmankhera, Lucknow**.
30. The **Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP)** is located at **Lucknow**.
31. Uttar Pradesh accounts for over **80% of India's total Mentha (Peppermint) oil output**, centred in **Barabanki, Badaun, Rampur, and Sambhal**.
32. **Malihabad (Lucknow)** is world-renowned for its GI-tagged **Dasheri Mango**.

33. **Prayagraj (Allahabad)** and Kaushambi are famous for the **Allahabad Surkha Guava** (red flesh, GI-tagged).
34. **Pratapgarh district** is the largest producer of **Aonla (Indian Gooseberry)** in India.
35. **Mahoba** is historically celebrated for its high-grade **Paan (Betel Vine / Bareja)** cultivation.
36. **Chandra Shekhar Azad University of Agriculture & Technology (CSAUAT)** was established at **Kanpur in 1975**.
37. **Acharya Narendra Deva University of Agriculture & Technology (ANDUAT)** was established at **Kumarganj (Ayodhya) in 1975**.
38. **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel University of Agriculture & Technology (SVPUAT)** was established at **Meerut in 2000**.
39. **Banda University of Agriculture & Technology (BUAT)** was established at **Banda in 2010**.
40. **Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University** was established in **Jhansi in 2014** by an Act of Parliament.
41. The first agricultural university of undivided Uttar Pradesh was **Govind Ballabh Pant University of Agriculture & Technology (GBPUAT)**, set up at **Pantnagar in 1960** (now in Uttarakhand).
42. The **Arjun Sahayak Project** provides irrigation to Mahoba, Banda, and Hamirpur using waters of the Dhasan River.
43. **Western Uttar Pradesh** was the principal beneficiary of the **Green Revolution (1960s)** in UP due to canal and tubewell networks.
44. **Bundelkhand** is the primary **pulses (gram, lentil, arhar)** and **oilseeds (sesame, mustard)** producing region of UP.
45. **Saryupar Plain** (Gorakhpur, Deoria, Basti) has witnessed the fastest growth in shallow tubewell irrigation.
46. The **Pradeshik Cooperative Dairy Federation (PCDF)** markets milk under the popular brand name **"Parag"**.
47. Under the UP Bovine Breeding Policy, the **Frieswal crossbred cattle** was developed at **CIRC, Meerut**.
48. **Badua Dam** is located in **Bihar** (often placed as a distractor in UP PSC dam matching questions).
49. **Ahraura Dam, Adwa Dam, and Sirsi Dam** are located in **Mirzapur district**.
50. **Parichha Dam** is built on the **Betwa River in Jhansi district**.

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1854 ⟶ Upper Ganga Canal opened under Sir Proby Cautley (origin: Haridwar)
1878 ⟶ Lower Ganga Canal commissioned (origin: Narora, Bulandshahr)
1928 ⟶ Sarda Canal commissioned (origin: Banbasa on Sarda river; longest canal network in UP)
1960 ⟶ Govind Ballabh Pant University of Agriculture & Technology established at Pantnagar (undivided UP)
1989 ⟶ 9 Agro-Climatic Zones delineated for UP by the Planning Commission
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: The 9 Agro-Climatic Zones of Uttar Pradesh (Planning Commission Classification)

AGRO-CLIMATIC ZONE	GEOGRAPHICAL EXTENT & KEY DISTRICTS	SOIL TYPE & CLIMATIC FEATURES	ANNUAL RAINFALL RANGE	PRINCIPAL CROPS & AGRICULTURAL SPECIALIZATION
1. Bhabhar & Terai Zone	Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj, Kushinagar	High moisture, rich clayey-loam alluvium with high organic matter; sub-humid	**1,200 – 1,500 mm** (High rainfall)	**Paddy, Sugarcane, Wheat, Jute, Mustard, Mentha, Kalanamak Rice**
2. Western Plain Zone	Meerut, Baghpat, Bulandshahr, Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Hapur, Muzaffarnagar, Shamli, Saharanpur	Fertile light/medium sandy loam; semi-arid to sub-humid	**600 – 800 mm**	**Sugarcane (Co-0238), Wheat, Maize, Mustard, Potato, Fodder crops**
3. Mid-Western Plain Zone	Badaun, Shahjahanpur, Moradabad, Sambhal, Amroha, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit	Sandy loam to clayey alluvium; sub-humid	**800 – 1,000 mm**	**Wheat, Sugarcane, Rice, Mentha (Peppermint), Mustard, Pulses**
4. South-Western Semi-Arid Zone	Agra, Mathura, Firozabad, Mainpuri, Aligarh, Hathras, Etah, Kasganj	Alluvial soil with sandy loam and saline/alkaline patches; semi-arid	**600 – 750 mm** (Lowest rainfall)	**Mustard (Rapeseed), Wheat, Bajra (Pearl Millet), Barley, Potato**
5. Central Plain Zone	Lucknow, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Sitapur, Hardoi, Kanpur Nagar, Kanpur Dehat, Fatehpur, Kaushambi, Prayagraj, Pratapgarh	Medium to heavy alluvial loam with *Reh / Usar* (saline-alkali) tracts	**800 – 1,000 mm**	**Wheat, Paddy, Gram, Potato, Guava (Surkha), Aonla, Dasheri Mango**
6. Bundelkhand Zone	Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot (7 districts)	Mixed red and black soils (*Rakar, Parwa, Kabar, Mar*); semi-arid, rocky	**800 – 950 mm** (Erratic, prone to drought)	**Gram (Chana), Lentil (Masoor), Arhar, Mustard, Sesame (Til), Jowar**
7. North-Eastern Plain Zone	Gorakhpur, Deoria, Kushinagar, Maharajganj, Basti, Sant Kabir Nagar, Siddharthnagar, Gonda, Bahraich	Deep alluvial silt and clay loam; sub-humid to humid	**1,000 – 1,200 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Sugarcane, Lentils, Maize, Mustard**
8. Eastern Plain Zone	Varanasi, Jaunpur, Ghazipur, Azamgarh, Mau, Ballia, Chandauli, Faizabad (Ayodhya), Ambedkar Nagar, Sultanpur, Amethi	Medium alluvial loam, clay loam (*Khadar* in floodplains); sub-humid	**1,000 – 1,200 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Pulses (Arhar/Gram), Sugarcane, Vegetables, Potato**
9. Vindhyan Zone	Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, southern parts of Prayagraj and Chandauli	Undulating red gravelly, sandy loam, lateritic soils; sub-humid to dry	**1,000 – 1,100 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Gram, Arhar, Mustard, Millets (Kodo/Kutki), Sesame**

Table 2: Major Canal Networks, Dams and Irrigation Systems in Uttar Pradesh

CANAL NETWORK / DAM PROJECT	RIVER / WATER SOURCE	OFFTAKE / BARRAGE LOCATION	TOTAL SYSTEM LENGTH / COMMAND AREA	BENEFICIARY DISTRICTS & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION
Upper Ganga Canal (1854)	**Ganga River**	**Bhimgoda Barrage, Haridwar** (Uttarakhand)	Main canal: ~295 km; Total system: ~6,500 km	• Designed by **Sir Proby T. Cautley**; opened on **8 April 1854**. • Irrigates Western UP: Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Bulandshahr, Aligarh, Mathura, Agra, Etawah, Kanpur.
Lower Ganga Canal (1878)	**Ganga River**	**Narora Barrage, Bulandshahr**	Main canal: ~100 km; Total system: ~8,200 km	• Opened in **1878**. • Supplies cooling water to Narora Atomic Power Station; irrigates Bulandshahr, Aligarh, Etah, Mainpuri, Farrukhabad, Kanpur, Fatehpur, Prayagraj.
Sharda Canal System (1928)	**Sharda (Kali) River**	**Banbasa Barrage** (Pilibhit / Champawat border)	Total network length: **~12,368 km** (Longest canal network in UP)	• Commissioned in **1928**. • Irrigates 16 districts of Central and Terai UP: Pilibhit, Bareilly, Shahjahanpur, Lakhimpur, Hardoi, Sitapur, Lucknow, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Barabanki, Prayagraj.
Eastern Yamuna Canal	**Yamuna River**	**Tajewala / Hathinikund Barrage** (Saharanpur border)	Total system: ~1,440 km	• Originally dug during Mughal era (Shah Jahan); remodeled by British engineers (Col. John Colvin) in **1830**. • Irrigates Saharanpur, Shamli, Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Baghpat, Ghaziabad.
Agra Canal (1874)	**Yamuna River**	**Okhla Barrage, Delhi**	Total system: ~1,600 km	• Opened in **1874**. • Traverses Delhi, Haryana, and irrigates Mathura, Agra, and parts of Rajasthan (Bharatpur).
Sarda Sahayak Project	**Ghaghara & Sharda Rivers**	**Katarniaghat Barrage** (Bahraich) on Ghaghara & Sharda feeder canal	Huge feeder channel (~260 km)	• Augments water supply to the tail-ends of the Sharda Canal system in Awadh and Purvanchal (Lucknow, Rae Bareli, Sultanpur, Jaunpur, Azamgarh, Ghazipur).
Saryu Nahar National Project	**5 Rivers: Ghaghara, Saryu, Rapti, Banganga, Rohini**	Barrages on Ghaghara, Saryu, and Rapti	Over **6,600 km** of canals; dedicated Dec 2021	• Massive project benefiting ~29 lakh farmers across **9 districts of Eastern UP**: Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Gonda, Siddharthnagar, Basti, Sant Kabir Nagar, Gorakhpur, Maharajganj.
Ken-Betwa River Interlinking	**Ken & Betwa Rivers**	**Daudhan Dam** (Chhatarpur, MP) & 221 km link canal	Transfers surplus water from Ken basin to Betwa basin	• **India's first National River Interlinking Project** under implementation. • Provides critical irrigation and drinking water to drought-prone **Bundelkhand** (Banda, Mahoba, Jhansi, Lalitpur in UP).
Matatila Dam (Rani Lakshmibai Dam)	**Betwa River**	**Lalitpur District** (UP-MP border)	Storage capacity: 1,132 MCM; 30.6 MW Hydel	• Constructed in **1958**; irrigates Jhansi, Jalaun, Hamirpur, and Lalitpur via Betwa canal network.
Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)	**Rihand River** (Tributary of Son)	**Pipri, Sonbhadra District**	Reservoir surface area: ~466 km^2 (Largest man-made reservoir in India)	• Constructed in **1962**; concrete gravity dam powering HINDALCO aluminium plant and thermal stations, feeding canals in Sonbhadra/Mirzapur.

Table 3: Premier Central & State Agricultural, Veterinary & Forest Research Institutes in UP

RESEARCH INSTITUTE / UNIVERSITY	LOCATION / DISTRICT	CONTROLLING BODY / AFFILIATION	FOUNDING YEAR	CORE SCIENTIFIC FOCUS & MANDATE
Indian Institute of Pulses Research (IIPR)	**Kalyanpur, Kanpur**	ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research)	**1983**	National nodal research institute for genetic improvement, crop management, and seed production of pulses (chana, arhar, moong, masoor).
Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research (IISR)	**Lucknow (Telibagh)**	ICAR	**1952**	Spearheads sugarcane breeding, mechanization, ratoon management, and bio-energy technologies.
National Sugar Institute (NSI)	**Kalyanpur, Kanpur**	Dept of Food & Public Distribution, GoI	**1936**	Premier institute for sugar technology, sugar engineering, alcohol technology, and fermentation technology (NOT under ICAR).
Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (IIVR)	**Jakhini, Varanasi**	ICAR	**1999**	Lead institute for vegetable germplasm breeding, disease resistance, and hybrid vegetable production (Kashi hybrid varieties).
Indian Veterinary Research Institute (IVRI)	**Izatnagar, Bareilly**	ICAR (Deemed University)	**1889**	India's premier veterinary institute; research in livestock health, vaccine manufacturing, and animal genetics.
Central Avian Research Institute (CARI)	**Izatnagar, Bareilly**	ICAR	**1979**	Specializes in poultry breeding (chicken, quail, turkey, guinea fowl), nutrition, and processing.
Central Institute for Research on Goats (CIRG)	**Makhdoom, Farah (Mathura)**	ICAR	**1979**	Dedicated to goat genetics (Jamunapari, Barbari), reproductive biotechnology, and goat meat/milk products.
Central Cattle Breeding Farm / CIRC	**Meerut (Brahmpuri)**	ICAR	**1987**	Research on cattle genetic improvement (Frieswal crossbred cattle) and indigenous bovine breeds (Sahiwal, Gir).
Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute (IGFRI)	**Jhansi**	ICAR	**1962**	National research on forage crops, pastures, silvopasture systems, and grassland management in semi-arid zones.
Central Agroforestry Research Institute (CAFRI)	**Jhansi**	ICAR	**1988**	Develops sustainable agroforestry models, watershed management, and tree-crop integration for rainfed regions.
Central Potato Research Station (CPRS)	**Modipuram, Meerut**	ICAR-CPRI (Shimla Sub-station)	**1957**	Breeder seed production and potato breeding for the Indo-Gangetic plains (Kufri varieties).
International Potato Center - South Asia Regional Centre (CIP-SARC)	**Singna, Agra**	CIP (Consultative Group on International Agri Research)	**2023**	Global centre for potato and sweet potato breeding, climate resilience, and seed technology (Note: Located at Singna, Agra; NOT Aligarh).
International Rice Research Institute - South Asia Regional Centre (IRRI-SARC)	**Varanasi (NSRTC Campus)**	IRRI (Philippines / ICAR)	**2018**	Regional hub for climate-resilient, bio-fortified rice varieties, direct-seeded rice (DSR), and grain quality labs.
Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture (CISH)	**Rehmankhera, Lucknow**	ICAR	**1972**	Nodal institute for subtropical fruits (Mango, Guava, Papaya, Bael, Jamun) and pest management.
National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI)	**Lucknow**	CSIR (Council of Scientific & Industrial Research)	**1953**	Plant taxonomy, floriculture, phytoremediation, and herbal drug standardization.
Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP)	**Lucknow**	CSIR	**1959**	Research on aromatic crops (Mentha/Peppermint, Lemongrass, Palmarosa) and herbal extracts.

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **9 Agro-Climatic Zones of UP**: 1. Tarai | 2. Western Plain | 3. Mid-Western Plain | 4. South-Western Semi-Arid 5. Central Plain | 6. Bundelkhand | 7. North-Eastern Plain | 8. Eastern Plain | 9. Vindhyan Zone
- **Source of Irrigation Hierarchy**: **Tube-wells (नलकूप ~72–74%) > Canals (नहर ~15%) > Wells (कुएं ~8%) > Tanks/Ponds (~1%)**
- **Agricultural National Ranks of UP**:
- **Rank 1**: Total Foodgrains, Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, Milk, Mango, Guava, Mentha oil
- **Rank 2**: Rice (after West Bengal), Groundnut (after Gujarat)
- **Premier Research Institutes**:
- **IIVR** (Vegetable): Varanasi | **IISR** (Sugarcane): Lucknow | **CIMAP** (Medicinal/Aromatic): Lucknow
- **CDRI** (Drug Research): Lucknow | **IVRI** (Veterinary): Bareilly (Izatnagar) | **CARA** (Avian): Bareilly
- **CIRG** (Goat Research): Makhdoom (Mathura) | **IGFRI** (Grassland/Fodder): Jhansi.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Which State is conventionally the largest producer of sugarcane in India? A. Maharashtra B. Uttar Pradesh C. Karnataka D. Tamil Nadu

▶ Show answer

Q2. Uttar Pradesh is also among the top producers of which tuber crop? A. Only tapioca B. Potato C. Only sweet potato D. Only cassava

▶ Show answer

Q3. Upper Ganga Canal takes off near: A. Haridwar B. Narora only C. Kanpur D. Varanasi

▶ Show answer

Q4. Among the following districts of Bihar, which has the highest annual sugarcane production? A. Rohtas B. West Champaran C. Patna D. Buxar

▶ Show answer

Q5. Which river is called the Sorrow of Bihar and drives major canal–flood projects? A. Gandak B. Kosi C. Son D. Punpun

▶ Show answer

Q6. Uttar Pradesh is the largest producer of which crop in India? A. Rice B. Wheat C. Sugarcane D. Cotton

▶ Show answer

Q7. The 'Upper Ganga Canal' -- one of the largest canal irrigation systems in India -- draws water from which river? A. Yamuna at Agra B. Ganga at Haridwar C. Ghaghra at Bahraich D. Sharda at Banbasa

▶ Show answer

Q8. The Minimum Support Price (MSP) for agricultural crops in India is recommended by which body? A. NABARD B. NITI Aayog C. Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) D. Food Corporation of India (FCI)

▶ Show answer

Q9. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Tube-wells (Nalkoop) account for approximately 74.9% of the net irrigated area in UP. B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Canals applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Canals (Nahar) constitute the second largest source of irrigation in UP (~15.2%). C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Private applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Private tube-wells alone irrigate over 71% of UP's cultivated farm area. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Matatila applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Matatila Dam (Rani Lakshmibai Dam) is built on the Betwa River in Lalitpur district.

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar), the largest reservoir by volume in India, is built on the Rihand River at Pipri (Sonbhadra). B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Chandauli applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Chandauli district is traditionally known as the "Rice Bowl of Uttar Pradesh" (Dhan ka Katora). C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Malihabad applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys C. Malihabad (Lucknow) is world-renowned for its GI-tagged Dasheri Mango. D. Classified under Schedule VII List II (State List)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 07: UP Special Topic 6 — Society, Demographics, Tribes, Education System and Social Development

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. As per Census 2011, the total population of Uttar Pradesh is **199,812,341** (~**19.98 Crore**).
2. Uttar Pradesh accounts for **16.51% of the total population of India**.
3. If UP were an independent nation, it would be the **5th most populous country in the world**.
4. The **decadal population growth rate** of UP during 2001–2011 was **20.22%** (India: 17.70%).
5. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (49.1%)** recorded the highest decadal growth rate in UP, while **Kanpur Nagar (9.9%)** recorded the lowest.
6. The **population density** of Uttar Pradesh is **829 persons per square kilometer** (India: 382).
7. **Ghaziabad (3,971 persons/km^2)** has the highest population density, while **Lalitpur (242 persons/km^2)** has the lowest.
8. The **sex ratio** of Uttar Pradesh is **912 females per 1000 males** (India: 943).
9. **Jaunpur (1,024)** has the highest sex ratio in UP, followed by Azamgarh (1,019) and Deoria (1,017).
10. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (851)** has the lowest sex ratio in UP.
11. The **child sex ratio (0–6 years)** in UP is **902** (India: 919).
12. **Balrampur (950)** has the highest child sex ratio, while **Baghpat (841)** has the lowest.
13. The **overall literacy rate** of Uttar Pradesh is **67.68%** (Male: 77.28%, Female: 57.18%).
14. The gender gap in literacy in UP is **20.10%**.
15. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)** has the highest overall literacy rate in UP.
16. **Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)** has the highest **female literacy rate** in UP.
17. **Shravasti (46.74%)** has the lowest literacy rate in UP across all three metrics (Overall 46.74%, Male 57.16%, Female 34.78%).
18. **77.73%** of UP's population resides in rural areas, while **22.27%** resides in urban areas.
19. **Ghaziabad (67.6%)** has the highest percentage of urban population in UP.
20. **Shravasti (96.54%)** has the highest percentage of rural population (and lowest urban percentage at 3.46%).
21. **Prayagraj (59.54 Lakh)** is the most populous district in UP, while **Mahoba (8.75 Lakh)** is the least populous.
22. The **Scheduled Caste (SC)** population of UP is **4.14 Crore**, constituting **20.69%** of the state's population.
23. Uttar Pradesh has the **largest absolute SC population in India**.
24. **Kaushambi (34.72%)** has the highest percentage of SC population in UP.
25. **Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)** has the highest absolute number of Scheduled Castes in UP.
26. **Baghpat** has both the lowest SC percentage (11.44%) and lowest SC count (1.49 Lakh) in UP.
27. The **Scheduled Tribe (ST)** population of UP is **11.34 Lakh**, constituting only **0.57%** of the state's population.
28. **Sonbhadra** has the highest tribal population in UP, both in absolute terms (3.85 Lakh) and percentage (**20.67%**).
29. The **Tharu tribe** is the most populous scheduled tribe in Uttar Pradesh.
30. The Tharu tribe inhabits the **Terai region** (Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Maharajganj).
31. The Tharu tribe traditionally commemorates **Diwali as a day of mourning / sorrow (*Shoka Parva*)**.
32. The **Bajhar festival** is celebrated by the **Tharu tribe**.

33. The traditional wedding feast of the Tharu community is called **Lathmarva Bhoj**.
34. The **Buxa (Bhoksa) tribe** is primarily concentrated in **Bijnor district**.
35. The Buxa tribe reveres **Chamunda Devi** as their supreme deity.
36. The **Sahariya tribe** is found exclusively in **Lalitpur district** in UP.
37. The **Agariya tribe** (traditional iron smelters) is concentrated in **Sonbhadra district**.
38. The **Kharwar tribe** performs the traditional **Karma dance** and is found in Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, and Chandauli.
39. The **University of Allahabad**, established on **23 September 1887**, was historically renowned as the **"Oxford of the East"**.
40. **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)** was founded in **1916** by **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya**.
41. **Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)** evolved from the **MAO College**, founded in **1875** by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**.
42. **Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University (BBAU)** is a Central University situated at **Lucknow** (est. 1996).
43. **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur** was established in **1959** under the Kanpur Indo-American Program.
44. The **Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Lucknow** was founded in **1984**.
45. The **Central Drug Research Institute (CDRI)** is located at **Lucknow** (developed the contraceptive pill 'Saheli').
46. The **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)** is situated at **Lucknow**.
47. The **Harish-Chandra Research Institute (HRI)**, dedicated to Mathematics and Theoretical Physics, is located at **Jhunsi, Prayagraj**.
48. The **V.V. Giri National Labour Institute** is located at **Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**.
49. **King George's Medical University (KGMU)** and **SGPGIMS** are located at **Lucknow**.
50. **Sampurnanand Sanskrit University** (Varanasi) traces its origin to the **Sanskrit College** established by **Jonathan Duncan in 1791**.

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1875 ⟶ Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College founded by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan (became AMU in 1920)
1887 ⟶ Allahabad University established ("Oxford of the East"; 4th oldest university in India)
1916 ⟶ Banaras Hindu University (BHU) founded by Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya
1921 ⟶ University of Lucknow established
1967 ⟶ First 5 Scheduled Tribes of UP notified (Tharu, Buksa, Bhotia, Jaunsari, Raji)
2003 ⟶ 10 additional Scheduled Tribes notified in Uttar Pradesh
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: Census 2011 Master Demographic Matrix for Uttar Pradesh (State Aggregate vs District Extremes)

DEMOGRAPHIC INDICATOR	UP STATE AGGREGATE	ALL-INDIA COMPARISON	TOP-RANKED UP DISTRICT (HIGHEST)	BOTTOM-RANKED UP DISTRICT (LOWEST)	CRUCIAL EXAMINATION NOTES & TRAPS
Total Population	**199,812,341** (~**19.98 Crore**)	**16.51%** of India's population (Rank **#1**)	**Prayagraj** (59.54 Lakh) > Moradabad > Ghaziabad	**Mahoba** (8.75 Lakh) < Chitrakoot < Hamirpur	If UP were an independent nation, it would be the **5th most populous country** in the world (after China, India, USA, Indonesia).
Decadal Growth Rate (2001–2011)	**20.22%**	India: 17.70% (UP growth is higher)	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (49.1%)** > Ghaziabad > Shravasti	**Kanpur Nagar (9.9%)** < Hamirpur < Baghpat	Urban satellite boom in NCR drove GB Nagar; industrial Kanpur stabilized.
Population Density	**829 persons / km²**	India: 382 persons / km² (Rank **#4** among major states)	**Ghaziabad (3,971 / km²)** > Varanasi > Lucknow	**Lalitpur (242 / km²)** < Sonbhadra (270) < Hamirpur	Lalitpur is the only district with density <300 in UP.
Sex Ratio (Females per 1000 Males)	**912**	India: 943 (UP deficit = -31)	**Jaunpur (1,024)** > Azamgarh (1,019) > Deoria (1,017)	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (851)** = Kanpur Dehat / Hardoi (856)	Only **3 districts** in UP have a sex ratio above 1,000 (Jaunpur, Azamgarh, Deoria).
Child Sex Ratio (0–6 Age Group)	**902**	India: 919 (Severe rural-urban distortion)	**Balrampur (950)** > Sant Kabir Nagar > Bahraich	**Baghpat (841)** < Gautam Buddha Nagar (843) < Ghaziabad	Western UP NCR districts exhibit alarming child sex ratio deficits.
Overall Literacy Rate	**67.68%** (~**67.7%**)	India: 73.0% / 74.04%	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)** > Kanpur Nagar > Auraiya	**Shravasti (46.74%)** < Bahraich (49.4%) < Balrampur	Shravasti is the lowest across ALL three literacy indices (Overall, Male, Female).
Male Literacy Rate	**77.28%** (~**77.3%**)	India: 80.88% / 82.14%	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (88.06%)** > Auraiya > Etawah	**Shravasti (57.16%)** < Bahraich < Balrampur	Gender gap in literacy in UP is **20.10%**.
Female Literacy Rate	**57.18%** (~**57.2%**)	India: 64.64% / 65.46%	**Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)** > Lucknow > Gautam Buddha Nagar	**Shravasti (34.78%)** < Balrampur (37.6%) < Bahraich	Notice that Kanpur Nagar leads female literacy, NOT Gautam Buddha Nagar!
Rural vs Urban Population	• Rural: **77.73%** (15.53 Cr) • Urban: **22.27%** (4.45 Cr)	India: Rural 68.84%, Urban 31.16%	• **Highest Urban %**: **Ghaziabad (67.6%)** > Lucknow (66.2%) • **Highest Rural %**: **Shravasti (96.5%)**	• **Lowest Urban %**: **Shravasti (3.46%)** • **Lowest Rural %**: **Ghaziabad (32.4%)**	UP is heavily rural; absolute urban count (4.45 Cr) is #2 in India after Maharashtra.
Scheduled Caste (SC) Population	**41,357,608** (**20.69%** ~ **20.7%** of UP population)	**16.6%** of India (UP has the largest absolute SC population in India)	• **Highest SC %**: **Kaushambi (34.72%)** > Sitapur > Hardoi • **Highest SC Count**: **Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)**	• **Lowest SC %**: **Baghpat (11.44%)** < Bareilly < Balrampur • **Lowest SC Count**: **Baghpat (1.49 Lakh)**	UP leads India in **absolute SC count**; Punjab leads India in **SC percentage** (31.9%).
Scheduled Tribe (ST) Population	**1,134,273** (**0.57%** of UP population)	**8.6%** of India (Very small tribal proportion in UP)	• **Highest ST %**: **Sonbhadra (20.67%)** > Lalitpur (5.86%) • **Highest ST Count**: **Sonbhadra (3.85 Lakh)**	• **Lowest ST % & Count**: **Baghpat / Kannauj / Jalaun / Badaun / Ayodhya**	Sonbhadra accounts for over one-third of UP's total tribal population.

Table 2: Scheduled Tribes of Uttar Pradesh (Ethnography, Customs & Distribution)

SCHEDULED TRIBE	PRIMARY DISTRICTS OF HABITAT	CULTURAL CUSTOMS, SOCIAL ORGANIZATION & BELIEFS	TRADITIONAL FESTIVALS & RITUALS	KEY EXAMINATION FACT
Tharu Tribe	**Terai Belt**: Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Maharajganj	• Matrilineal joint family tradition; women hold dominant household status. • Traditional houses built of bamboo and reed (*Narhul*). • Claim descent from the Rajput royal line of Thar desert (Rajasthan).	• **Celebrates Diwali as a day of mourning / sorrow (*Shoka Parva*)**, offering *Putla Vidhan* to ancestors. • Celebrates **Bajhar festival** in Jyeshtha/Ashadha month. • Perform *Lathmarva Bhoj* in marriage ceremonies.	• **Most populous tribe in Uttar Pradesh**. • Rajiv Gandhi National Tribal College / Tharu Vikas Pariyojana established in Lakhimpur Kheri (1980).
Buxa / Bhoksa Tribe	**Bijnor District** (and foothills of Pilibhit/Kumaon border)	• Patrilineal social structure with gotra divisions (Buxa Rajput, Buxa Brahmin, Buxa Ahir). • Practice bride-price (*Kanya Shulk*) and levirate/sororate marriage.	• Worship **Chamunda Devi** (Kashipur) as their supreme deity. • Celebrate Chaiti Mela at Kashipur and traditional Hindu festivals.	• Second major tribe in Terai; concentrated heavily in **Bijnor district**.
Jaunsari Tribe	**Foothills of Saharanpur** (bordering Dehradun/Jaunsar-Bawar)	• Historically practiced fraternal polyandry (*Draupadi Vivah*). • Folk dances: *Harul*, *Raso*, *Ghumsu*.	• Worship Mahasu Devta (manifestation of Lord Shiva). • Celebrate Magh Mela and Bisu festival.	• After bifurcation in 2000, main population stayed in Uttarakhand (Dehradun), with fringes in Saharanpur.
Kharwar (Khairwar) Tribe	**Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Deoria, Ballia**	• Historically associated with traditional extraction of Catechu (*Katha*) from Khair trees (*Acacia catechu*). • Known for physical valour and martial traditions.	• Perform the famous **Karma Dance** during autumn/spring harvest. • Worship Badadeoji, Dulhadeo, and Bansapti Devi.	• Major tribal group of the Vindhyan and Sonbhadra plateau region.
Sahariya Tribe	**Lalitpur District** (exclusively)	• Forest-dwelling indigenous group; highly vulnerable tribal group (PVTG).	• Worship forest deities; celebrate traditional tribal dances (*Sahar*, *Lahanga*).	• **Confined exclusively to Lalitpur district** in UP.
Parhaiya / Baiga / Agariya / Chero / Bhuiya	**Sonbhadra District** (exclusively)	• **Agariya**: Traditional iron smelters using charcoal furnaces. • **Baiga**: Traditional herbal medicine practitioners and priest/shaman (*Guniya*). • **Chero & Bhuiya**: Forest gatherers and marginal farmers.	• Nature-worshipping festivals, Sarhul, Karma, and Phagua.	• Sonbhadra is the most tribally diverse district in UP, hosting nearly **10 recognized ST sub-groups**.

Table 3: Premier Central Universities, State Technical Universities, Medical & Scientific Research Institutes in UP

CATEGORY	INSTITUTION NAME	LOCATION / DISTRICT	ESTABLISHED YEAR	ACADEMIC & SCIENTIFIC EMINENCE
Central University	**University of Allahabad**	**Prayagraj**	**1887** (Central status in 2005)	4th oldest university in India; traditionally revered as the **"Oxford of the East"** for producing civil servants and statesmen.
Central University	**Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**	**Varanasi**	**1916**	Founded by **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya** under the BHU Act, 1915; Asia's largest residential university (features IIT BHU & IMS).
Central University	**Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)**	**Aligarh**	**1920**	Evolved from the **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College** founded in **1875** by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**.
Central University	**Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University (BBAU)**	**Lucknow**	**1996**	Central university dedicated to social justice, technology, and inclusive higher education.
Central University	**Rajiv Gandhi National Aviation University (RGNAU)**	**Fursatganj (Amethi)**	**2013**	India's first specialized central aviation university.
Central University	**Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University**	**Jhansi**	**2014**	Central agricultural university established for the Bundelkhand region.
Premier Tech Institute	**Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur**	**Kanpur (Kalyanpur)**	**1959**	One of the foremost IITs, established under the Kanpur Indo-American Program (KIAP).
Premier Tech Institute	**Motilal Nehru National Institute of Technology (MNNIT)**	**Prayagraj**	**1961** (NIT status 2002)	Premier National Institute of Technology; pioneer in computer science education.
Premier Tech Institute	**Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT)**	**Prayagraj (Jhalwa)**	**1999**	Institute of National Importance for information technology, AI, and robotics.
Management / Labour	**Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Lucknow**	**Lucknow (Prabandh Nagar)**	**1984**	4th IIM established in India; premier management institution.
Management / Labour	**V.V. Giri National Labour Institute**	**Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**	**1974**	Autonomous body under the Ministry of Labour & Employment, GoI, for labour economics and industrial relations.
Fundamental Research	**Harish-Chandra Research Institute (HRI)**	**Jhunsi, Prayagraj**	**1966**	Autonomous research institute funded by DAE (Department of Atomic Energy), specializing in Higher Mathematics and Theoretical Physics.
Medical / Health	**Sanjay Gandhi Postgraduate Institute of Medical Sciences (SGPGIMS)**	**Lucknow (Raebareli Road)**	**1983**	Premier tertiary super-specialty medical institute and hospital.
Medical / Health	**King George's Medical University (KGMU)**	**Lucknow (Chowk)**	**1911** (Upgraded 2002)	Iconic medical university established by King George V (as Prince of Wales).
CSIR Cluster Lucknow	• **CDRI** (Central Drug Research Institute - 1951) • **IITR** (Indian Institute of Toxicology Research - 1965) • **NBRI** (National Botanical Research Institute - 1953) • **CIMAP** (Central Inst. of Medicinal & Aromatic Plants - 1959)	**Lucknow**	1951–1965	Lucknow is one of India's largest CSIR biological research clusters (developed drugs like *Centchroman/Saheli* and *Arteether*).
Palaeobotany	**Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)**	**Lucknow**	**1946**	Founded by renowned palaeobotanist **Prof. Birbal Sahni**; global centre for fossil plant and palaeoclimate research.
Fisheries Genetics	**National Bureau of Fish Genetic Resources (NBFGR)**	**Telibagh, Lucknow**	**1983**	ICAR institute for cataloguing and conserving fish genetic resources and aquatic biodiversity.

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **UP Tribal Demography**:
- Total ST Population in UP: **11.34 Lakh (only 0.57% of state total)** — very small proportion!
- District with Highest ST Population: **Sonbhadra** (both in absolute count & percentage: 20.67%)
- Districts with ZERO STs: **Ayodhya (Faizabad) and Jalaun**
- **Tharu Tribe Traps**:
- Largest tribal group in UP; inhabit the **Terai belt** (Lakhimpur, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur).
- Observe **Diwali as a day of mourning (शोक पर्व)**.

- Follow joint family system; brew rice liquor called **Jad** (जाड़).
- **Buksa (Bhoksa) Tribe**: Concentrated in **Bijnor district**; follow Pratiloma/Anuloma marriages; worship Kashipur Goddess.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Which of the following districts of Uttar Pradesh has the lowest female literacy rate as per 2011 census? A. Rampur B. Balrampur C. Shrawasti D. Bahraich

▶ Details

Q7. Which districts of Uttarakhand recorded negative population growth during 2001–2011? A. Dehradun and Haridwar B. Pauri Garhwal and Almora C. Nainital and Udham Singh Nagar D. Champawat and Pithoragarh

▶ Show answer

Q8. Literacy rate of Uttarakhand (Census 2011) was about: A. 74.04% B. 67.7% C. 78.82% D. 63.8%

▶ Show answer

Q9. According to Census 2011, work participation rate in India and Rajasthan respectively was: A. 43.6% and 41.8% B. 39.8% and 43.6% C. 42.4% and 41.8% D. 39.8% and 36.4%

▶ Show answer

Q10. Literacy rate in West Bengal (Census 2011) is— A. 97% B. 70% C. 80% D. 77%

▶ Show answer

Q11. India is regarded as a country with "Demographic Dividend". This is due to: A. Its high population in the age group below 15 years B. Its high population in the age group of 15–64 years C. Its high population in the age group above 65 years D. Its high total population

▶ Show answer

Q12. Which district of Uttar Pradesh has the lowest female literacy rate as per Census 2011? A. Bahraich B. Balrampur C. Shravasti D. Badaun

▶ Show answer

Q13. The 'Right to Education' Act 2009 provides free and compulsory education to children in which age group? A. 5-14 years B. 6-14 years C. 5-16 years D. 6-18 years

▶ Show answer

Q14. The 'Kanya Sumangala Yojana' of Uttar Pradesh provides financial support to a girl child at how many stages of her life? A. 4 B. 5 C. 6 D. 7

▶ Show answer

Chapter 08: UP Special Topic 7 — Transport, Tourism Circuits, Forests, Protected Areas, Wetlands and Disaster Management

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Dudhwa National Park** in **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the **only National Park** in Uttar Pradesh (established 1977).
2. Uttar Pradesh has **4 designated Tiger Reserves**: (1) Dudhwa TR, (2) Pilibhit TR, (3) Amangarh TR, and (4) Ranipur TR.
3. **Ranipur Tiger Reserve** in **Chitrakoot district** was notified in **2022** as India's **53rd Tiger Reserve** and UP's 4th.
4. **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** won the international **TX2 Award in 2020** for doubling its wild tiger count ahead of schedule.
5. The scenic eco-tourism spot **Chuka Beach** is located inside **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** on the Sharda Sagar reservoir.
6. **Amangarh Tiger Reserve (Bijnor)** served as the buffer zone of Corbett National Park prior to the division of UP in 2000.
7. **Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Chandauli district** is the **oldest wildlife sanctuary** in UP (established in **1957**).
8. **Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary** (2,073 km^2) is the **largest wildlife sanctuary** in Uttar Pradesh by area.
9. **Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Lalitpur district** (5.4 km^2) is the **smallest wildlife sanctuary** in UP.
10. The **National Chambal Sanctuary** (Agra/Etawah) is a specialized tri-state sanctuary for the conservation of the **Gharial** and **Gangetic River Dolphin**.
11. **Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Bahraich district** was established in **1975** and is famous for Gangetic dolphins.
12. The **State Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*).
13. The **State Bird** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
14. The **State Tree** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Ashoka** (*Saraca asoca*).
15. The **State Flower** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Palash / Dhak** (*Butea monosperma*).
16. The **State Aquatic Animal** is the **Gangetic Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).
17. According to the India State of Forest Report (ISFR), the forest cover of Uttar Pradesh is **6.15%** of its total geographic area.
18. The tree cover of Uttar Pradesh is **3.08%** of its total area, making the total green cover **9.23%**.
19. **Sonbhadra district** has the highest forest cover in UP, both in absolute area (**2,528 km^2**) and percentage (**35.29%**).
20. **Bhadohi (Sant Ravidas Nagar)** has the lowest forest cover in UP (both in area: 3.71 km^2 and percentage: **0.37%**).
21. Only two districts in Uttar Pradesh have more than 20% forest cover: **Sonbhadra (35.29%)** and **Chandauli (21.78%)**.
22. The **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora)** was declared the **first Ramsar site** of Uttar Pradesh in **2005**.
23. **Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary) in Ballia** was declared **India's 100th Ramsar Site** on 5 June 2026.
24. **Sarsai Nawar Wetland** in **Etawah** is world-renowned for its dense congregation of vulnerable Sarus Cranes.
25. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)** in **Agra** is a Ramsar wetland featuring a specialized Bear Rescue Centre.
26. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Rae Bareli district**.
27. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Hardoi district**.
28. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Gonda district**.
29. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Mainpuri district**.
30. **Bakhira Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar wetland located in **Sant Kabir Nagar district**.
31. **Haiderpur Wetland** (Muzaffarnagar-Bijnor) was declared a Ramsar site in **December 2021**.

32. **Patna Bird Sanctuary** is located in **Jalesar (Etah district)**.
33. **Rudrasagar Lake** (Tripura), **Sultanpur National Park** (Haryana), and **Surinsar-Mansar** (J&K) are frequently tested Ramsar sites that are **NOT in Uttar Pradesh**.
34. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) was the first access-controlled expressway in UP, connecting Greater Noida to Agra.
35. The **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km) features a dedicated 3.3 km emergency airstrip in Unnao district.
36. The **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km) connects **Lucknow (Chand Saray) to Ghazipur (Haidariya)** via Mau (does NOT pass through Basti).
37. The **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km) connects **Chitrakoot (Bharatkoop) to Etawah (Kudrail)**.
38. The **Ganga Expressway** (594 km) connects **Meerut to Prayagraj**, traversing 12 districts.
39. Uttar Pradesh has **5 International Airports**: Lucknow, Varanasi, Kushinagar, Ayodhya Dham, and Noida (Jewar).
40. **Kushinagar Airport** was upgraded to international status on **24 June 2020** to facilitate Buddhist pilgrimage.
41. **Noida International Airport at Jewar** is located in **Gautam Buddha Nagar district**.
42. The headquarters of the **North Eastern Railway (NER)** is located at **Gorakhpur**.
43. The headquarters of the **North Central Railway (NCR)** is located at **Prayagraj (Subedarganj)**.
44. **Gorakhpur Railway Station** features one of the world's longest railway platforms at **1,366.3 metres**.
45. **National Waterway 1 (NW-1)** operates on the **Ganga River** connecting **Prayagraj to Haldia (1,620 km)**.
46. The country's first inland **Multimodal Freight Terminal** on NW-1 was inaugurated at **Ralhupur, Varanasi** in November 2018.
47. Uttar Pradesh has operational metro transit systems in **6 cities**: Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Noida-Greater Noida, Ghaziabad, and Meerut.
48. The **Taj Trapezium Zone (TTZ)** covers an area of **10,400 km²** around the Taj Mahal to prevent air pollution damage.
49. The **Uttar Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority (UPSDMA)** is headed by the **Chief Minister**.
50. **Eastern UP (Terai/Purvanchal)** is highly prone to **recurrent river floods**, while **Bundelkhand** is prone to **chronic agricultural drought**.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1936 ⟶ Hailey National Park established (first in India/Asia, in then undivided UP; now Corbett, UK)
1977 ⟶ Dudhwa declared a National Park (only National Park in UP today; Lakhimpur Kheri)
1987 ⟶ Dudhwa Tiger Reserve constituted under Project Tiger (incorporating Kishanpur)
2014 ⟶ Pilibhit Tiger Reserve notified (45th TR of India; won TX2 International Award in 2020)
2022 ⟶ Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot) declared UP's 4th Tiger Reserve (53rd in India)
2024 ⟶ UP operates 10 Ramsar Wetlands & over 1,225 km of Operational Expressways
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📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 1: National Parks, Tiger Reserves and Major Wildlife Sanctuaries in Uttar Pradesh

PROTECTED AREA / CATEGORY	LOCATION / DISTRICTS	ESTABLISHED YEAR / AREA	KEY FLORA & FAUNA SPECIES	STRATEGIC ENVIRONMENTAL & EXAM FOCUS
Dudhwa National Park	**Lakhimpur Kheri District**	**1977** (Declared NP); Area: **490 km²**	Sal forests (*Shorea robusta*), Swamp Deer (**Barasingha** — State Animal), Royal Bengal Tiger, One-Horned Rhinoceros (reintroduced 1984), Hispid Hare, Bengal Florican	• **Only National Park in Uttar Pradesh**. • Core zone of Dudhwa Tiger Reserve; encompasses moist Terai alluvial grassland and swamps.
Dudhwa Tiger Reserve	**Lakhimpur Kheri & Bahraich Districts**	**1987–88** (Project Tiger); Area: **2,201 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Elephants, Swamp Deer, Gangetic Dolphins, Gharials	• Comprises 3 contiguous units: (1) **Dudhwa National Park**, (2) **Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary**, (3) **Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary**.
Pilibhit Tiger Reserve	**Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri & Bahraich**	**2014** (Declared TR); Area: **730 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Swamp Deer, Bengal Florican, Fishing Cat	• Awarded the prestigious international **TX2 Award (2020)** for doubling its tiger population ahead of schedule. • Eco-tourism destination **Chuka Beach** is located on the Sharda Sagar reservoir inside Pilibhit TR.
Amangarh Tiger Reserve	**Bijnor District**	**2012** (Declared TR); Area: **95 km²**	Asian Elephants, Tigers, Sambar, Cheetal, Barking Deer	• Originally the buffer zone of **Jim Corbett National Park**; remained in UP after Corbett went to Uttarakhand in 2000.
Ranipur Tiger Reserve	**Chitrakoot District**	**2022** (Declared 53rd TR of India / 4th TR in UP); Area: **529.8 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Sloth Bears, Hyenas, Chowsingha (Four-horned Antelope), Blackbucks	• **First Tiger Reserve in the Bundelkhand region** of UP. • Vital wildlife corridor connecting Panna Tiger Reserve (MP) with the Vindhyan forests of UP.
Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary	**Chandauli District** (Vindhyan range)	**1957** (Oldest WLS in UP); Area: **78 km²**	Leopards, Chinkara, Blackbucks, Sambar, Waterfalls (Rajdari & Devdari)	• **Oldest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh** (est. 1957). • Historically selected for the Asiatic Lion introduction experiment (1957–1960).
Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary	**Meerut, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Hapur, Amroha**	**1986**; Area: **2,073 km²**	Swamp Deer, Gangetic Dolphin, Otters, Gharials, Hog Deer	• **Largest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh by area** (2,073 km^2). • Protects the alluvial floodplain biodiversity of the Upper Ganga.
Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary	**Lalitpur District** (Deogarh)	**1977**; Area: **5.4 km²**	Leopards, Jackals, Nilgai, Wild Boar, Vultures	• **Smallest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh** (5.4 km^2).
National Chambal Sanctuary	**Agra & Etawah Districts** (along Chambal River)	**1979**; Tri-state sanctuary (UP, MP, Rajasthan)	**Gharial** (*Gavialis gangeticus*), Red-crowned Roofed Turtle, Gangetic River Dolphin, Mugger Crocodile	• Special Riverine Sanctuary dedicated to the critically endangered fish-eating **Gharial** and freshwater Gangetic Dolphins.
Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary	**Bahraich District** (Terai belt)	**1975**; Area: **400 km²**	Gharials, Gangetic Dolphins, Tigers, Rhinoceros, Swamp Deer	• Part of Dudhwa TR; drained by the Girwa and Suheli rivers; premier habitat of Gangetic dolphins and gharials.
Kaimoor Wildlife Sanctuary	**Mirzapur & Sonbhadra Districts**	**1982**; Area: **500 km²**	Blackbuck, Chinkara, Leopards, Prehistoric Rock Paintings (*Lakhania Dari*)	• Forested sandstone plateau of the Kaimur Range overlooking the Son valley.
Sohagibarwa Wildlife Sanctuary	**Maharajganj District**	**1987**; Area: **428 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Pythons, King Cobra, Water Monitor Lizard	• Situated on the international border with Nepal in the Terai lowland.
Suhelwa Wildlife Sanctuary	**Balrampur, Shravasti & Gonda**	**1988**; Area: **452 km²**	Leopards, Sloth Bears, Barking Deer, Jungle Cat	• Stretches along the Indo-Nepal international boundary.

Table 2: Complete Ramsar Wetlands Matrix of Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh possesses one of the largest concentrations of **Ramsar Wetlands of International Importance** in India:

RAMSAR SITE / WETLAND	DISTRICT / LOCATION	RAMSAR INSCRIPTION DATE	SURFACE AREA (HECTARES)	ECOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE & FLAGSHIP AVIFAUNA
1. Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora)	**Bulandshahr, Hapur, Sambhal, Amroha, Badaun**	**8 November 2005**	**26,590 ha**	• **First Ramsar Site of Uttar Pradesh** (stretch of 85 km on the Ganga). • Home to Gangetic Dolphins, Gharials, Muggers, Otters, 12 species of freshwater turtles.
2. Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary)	**Unnao District** (Kanpur-Lucknow Road)	**19 September 2019**	**224.6 ha**	• Shallow monsoon-fed lake hosting >25,000 waterbirds; migratory Pintails, Greylag Geese, Mallards, and Cotton Teals.
3. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	**Rae Bareli District** (Salon tehsil)	**19 September 2019**	**799.4 ha**	• Perennial lowland wetland consisting of 6 interconnected water bodies; supports vulnerable **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
4. Sandi Bird Sanctuary	**Hardoi District**	**19 September 2019**	**308.5 ha**	• Natural freshwater marsh on the Garra River basin; critical drought refuge for Eurasian Wigeons and Red-crested Pochards.
5. Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	**Gonda District**	**19 September 2019**	**722 ha**	• Permanent freshwater oxbow lake system comprising two lakes (Parvati and Arga); critical nesting ground for White-rumped Vultures.
6. Saman Bird Sanctuary	**Mainpuri District**	**19 September 2019**	**526.3 ha**	• Seasonal oxbow lake on the Ganga floodplain; vital stopover for Central Asian Flyway waterfowl and Sarus Cranes.
7. Sarsai Nawar Wetland	**Etawah District**	**19 September 2019**	**161.3 ha**	• Permanent marshland supporting the highest non-breeding congregation of the vulnerable **Sarus Crane** in South Asia.
8. Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	**Agra District** (on Mathura Road)	**21 August 2020**	**431 ha**	• Man-made reservoir fed by Agra Canal; features a specialized **Bear Rescue Facility** and large breeding colonies of migratory waterfowl.
9. Haiderpur Wetland	**Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor Districts**	**8 December 2021**	**6,908 ha**	• Human-made wetland formed in 1984 by the construction of the Madhya Ganga Barrage within Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary; critical habitat for Swamp Deer and wintering migratory waterbirds.
10. Bakhira Bird Sanctuary	**Sant Kabir Nagar District**	**2 February 2022** (World Wetlands Day)	**2,894 ha**	• Largest natural flood-plain lake in Eastern UP; wintering refuge for over 40,000 birds across 30 species.
11. Shekha Jheel	**Aligarh District**	Designated Wetland / Ramsar Track	**25 ha**	• Fresh-water perennial lake adjacent to Upper Ganga Canal; sanctuary for winter migratory ducks.
12. Patna Bird Sanctuary	**Etah District** (Jalesar)	Designated Wetland / Wildlife Sanctuary	**109 ha**	• Notified sanctuary famous for dense water lily (*Kamal*) growth and massive congregation of wintering migratory birds.
13. Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary)	**Ballia District**	**5 June 2026** (World Environment Day)	**3,432 ha**	• Meandering floodplain oxbow lake near the Ganga-Saryu confluence; **India's 100th Ramsar Site**.

Table 3: Multimodal Transport Infrastructure of Uttar Pradesh

INFRASTRUCTURE SEGMENT	KEY HIGHLIGHTS / HEADQUARTER / EXTENT	OPERATING SCALE / TOTAL NETWORK	STRATEGIC SIGNIFICANCE & ECONOMIC IMPACT
Operational Expressways	• **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km: Greater Noida–Agra) • **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km: Agra–Lucknow) • **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km: Lucknow–Ghazipur) • **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km: Chitrakoot–Etawah) • **Delhi-Meerut Expressway** (96 km: 14-lane high-speed corridor)	Over **1,200 km** of operational 6-lane/4-lane access-controlled expressways	• UP is the **"Expressway State of India"**, accounting for >50% of the country's total operational expressway network.
Expressways Under Execution	• **Ganga Expressway** (594 km: Meerut–Prayagraj via 12 districts) • **Gorakhpur Link Expressway** (91.3 km: Jaitpur–Salarpur) • **Lucknow-Kanpur Expressway** (63 km) • **Chitrakoot-Prayagraj Link** & **Ganga Haridwar Extension**	Under construction by **UPEIDA**	• Transforms the logistics landscape by connecting Western UP directly to Purvanchal and Southern Bundelkhand.
International Airports	1. **Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport (Amausi, Lucknow)** 2. **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport (Babatpur, Varanasi)** 3. **Kushinagar International Airport** (Declared Intl: June 2020) 4. **Maharishi Valmiki International Airport (Ayodhya Dham)** (Dec 2023) 5. **Noida International Airport (Jewar, GB Nagar)** (Commercial: June 2026)	**5 Operational / Developing International Airports** (Highest for any state in India)	• Direct international connectivity for religious tourism (Kashi, Ayodhya, Buddhist circuit) and global trade/cargo logistics in NCR.
Railway Zonal Headquarters	1. **North Eastern Railway (NER)**: Headquartered at **Gorakhpur** 2. **North Central Railway (NCR)**: Headquartered at **Prayagraj (Subedarganj)**	2 Railway Zonal HQs located inside UP	• UP has the **largest railway route kilometer network in India** (>8,800 route km). • Gorakhpur features one of the world's longest railway platforms (1,366.3 metres).
Inland Waterway (National Waterway 1 - NW-1)	**Prayagraj (UP) to Haldia (West Bengal)** along the Ganga River	**1,620 km** (Jal Marg Vikas Project - World Bank assisted)	• India's first National Waterway. • **Multimodal Freight Terminal** operational at **Ralhupur, Varanasi** and floating cargo terminals at Prayagraj and Ghazipur.
Urban Rapid Transit / Metro	Operational in **6 Cities**: **Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Noida-Greater Noida (Aqua Line), Ghaziabad, Meerut (Metro + Namo Bharat RRTS)**	India's premier State with 6 operational metro transit cities	• Namo Bharat (Regional Rapid Transit System - RRTS) links Delhi–Ghaziabad–Meerut with operational speeds of $160 ext{ km/h}$.

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **4 Tiger Reserves of UP**: 1. **Dudhwa TR** (Lakhimpur Kheri) | 2. **Pilibhit TR** (Pilibhit) 3. **Amangarh TR** (Bijnor — buffer zone of Corbett) | 4. **Ranipur TR** (Chitrakoot — Bundelkhand's 1st TR!)
- **UP Ramsar Sites (10 Wetlands)**:
- **Upper Ganga River** (Brijghat to Narora — 1st in UP, 2005)
- **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)**: Agra | **Saman Sanctuary**: Mainpuri | **Samaspur**: Rae Bareli
- **Sandi Sanctuary**: Hardoi | **Parvati Arga**: Gonda | **Sarsai Nawar**: Etawah
- **Nawabganj (Chandra Shekhar Azad)**: Unnao | **Haiderpur Wetland**: Muzaffarnagar/Bijnor | **Bakhira**: Sant Kabir Nagar
- **Expressway Capital**:
- **Ganga Expressway**: 594 km (Meerut to Prayagraj — longest under construction)
- **Purvanchal Expressway**: 341 km (Lucknow to Ghazipur)
- **Agra-Lucknow Expressway**: 302 km | **Bundelkhand Expressway**: 296 km (Chitrakoot to Etawah).

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Dudhwa National Park is situated in which of the following districts of Uttar Pradesh? A. Lakhimpur Kheri B. Pilibhit C. Bahraich D. Sharavasti

▶ Show answer

Q2. Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Ramsar) is in: A. Ballia B. Sant Kabir Nagar C. Gonda D. Hardoi

▶ Show answer

Q3. Purvanchal Expressway roughly connects: A. Meerut to Prayagraj B. Lucknow region to Ghazipur C. Chitrakoot to Etawah D. Agra to Lucknow only

▶ Show answer

Q4. Which river is known as the 'Sorrow of Bihar'? A. Ganga B. Kosi C. Son D. Gandak

▶ Show answer

Q5. Which expressway in Uttar Pradesh, inaugurated in 2021, is the longest expressway in the State? A. Yamuna Expressway B. Agra-Lucknow Expressway C. Purvanchal Expressway D. Bundelkhand Expressway

▶ Show answer

Q6. 'Dudhwa National Park' in Uttar Pradesh is famous for the conservation of which endangered animal? A. Asiatic Lion B. Snow Leopard C. Barasingha (Swamp Deer) and Tiger D. One-horned Rhinoceros

▶ Show answer

Q7. The National Chambal Sanctuary in UP is known for the conservation of which critically endangered crocodilian? A. Saltwater Crocodile B. Mugger Crocodile C. Gharial (Gavial) D. Marsh Crocodile

▶ Show answer

Q8. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Dudhwa National Park in Lakhimpur Kheri is the only National Park in Uttar Pradesh (established 1977). B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q9. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Ranipur applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Ranipur Tiger Reserve in Chitrakoot district was notified in 2022 as India's 53rd Tiger Reserve and UP's 4th. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Pilibhit applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Pilibhit Tiger Reserve won the international TX2 Award in 2020 for doubling its wild tiger count ahead of schedule. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Amangarh applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amangarh Tiger Reserve (Bijnor) served as the buffer zone of Corbett National Park prior to the division of UP in 2000.

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary in Chandauli district is the oldest wildlife sanctuary in UP (established in 1957). B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Hastinapur applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary (2,073 km^2) is the largest wildlife sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh by area. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Mahavir applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys C. Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary in Lalitpur district (5.4 km^2) is the smallest wildlife sanctuary in UP. D. Classified under Schedule VII List II (State List)

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Katarniaghat applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Classified under Schedule VII List II (State List) C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary in Bahraich district was established in 1975 and is famous for Gangetic dolphins.

▶ Show answer

Chapter 09: UP Special Topic 8 — Government Schemes, State Policies, State Symbols, Honors and Miscellaneous Facts

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2024–2025	**UP Annual Budget Milestone** — State budget crosses **₹7.36 Lakh Crore**, pacing the target of becoming a **$1 Trillion Economy by 2027**	Macroeconomic scale and state fiscal priorities
2023–2024	**Ranipur Wildlife Sanctuary (Chitrakoot)** — Notified as UP's **4th Tiger Reserve** and India's **53rd Tiger Reserve**	Core wildlife conservation & protected areas
2023	**Ganga Expressway Execution (594 km)** — 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting Meerut to Prayagraj via 12 districts	Critical infrastructure & logistics corridor
2023	**UP ODOP Global Integration** — State ODOP products onboarded to ONDC and international trade pavilions	Industrial promotion & district craft branding
2022	**Bakhira Bird Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar)** — Added as UP's **10th Ramsar Wetland** (Wetland of International Importance)	Environmental geography & wetland conservation
Rolling	**District Administrative Realignment** — 75 Districts, 18 Divisions, 17 Municipal Corporations (Shahjahanpur 17th)	State administrative architecture baseline

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Uttar Pradesh Diwas (UP Day)** is officially celebrated every year on **24 January**.
2. On **24 January 1950**, the United Provinces was officially renamed as **Uttar Pradesh**.
3. The official **State Seal / Emblem** of Uttar Pradesh was formally adopted in **1938**.
4. The State Emblem of UP incorporates a **Bow and Arrow** (Lord Rama), a **Pair of Fish** (Nawabs of Awadh), and **Three Flowing Streams** (Triveni Sangam).
5. The **State Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*).
6. The **State Bird** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
7. The **State Tree** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Ashoka (Sita Ashoka)** (*Saraca asoca*).
8. The **State Flower** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Palash / Dhak / Tesu** (*Butea monosperma*).
9. **Palash** was officially declared as the State Flower on **4 January 2011**, replacing Brahmakamal.
10. The **State Aquatic Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Gangetic River Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).
11. The financial assistance under **Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana** is provided in **6 distinct stages**, totaling **₹25,000**.
12. Under Kanya Sumangala Yojana, the annual family income ceiling is capped at **₹3 Lakh**.
13. The **Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana** was launched on **Basant Panchami in February 2021** to provide free competitive exam coaching.
14. The **Vishwakarma Shram Samman Yojana** provides free 6-day skill training, modern toolkits, and subsidized bank loans to traditional village craftsmen.
15. The **Swami Vivekananda Youth Empowerment Scheme** distributes free smartphones and tablets to final-year college/technical students.
16. The **Nand Baba Milk Mission** was launched with an outlay of **₹1,000 Crore** in **June 2023** to boost indigenous bovine milk output.
17. The **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** provides a 50% capital subsidy for establishing 25-cow dairy farms of indigenous breeds.
18. **Kamdhenu Dairy Yojana** is an older standalone scheme and is **NOT** a component of the current Nand Baba Milk Mission.
19. Under the **UP Krishak Durghatna Kalyan Yojana**, compensation of **₹5 Lakh** is provided for accidental death or permanent disability of farmers.
20. **Mission Shakti** was launched during Shardiya Navratri in **October 2020** to ensure women's security, dignity, and self-reliance.
21. Dedicated **Women Help Desks (Mahila Helpdesk)** have been set up in all **1,535+ police stations** across Uttar Pradesh.
22. **Nivesh Mitra** is Uttar Pradesh's flagship digital single-window portal for industrial clearances and investor facilitation.
23. The **UP Gaurav Samman** is the highest state civilian honor, carrying a cash prize of **₹11 Lakh**.
24. The highest Hindi literary award of the Uttar Pradesh Hindi Sansthan is the **Bharat Bharti Puraskar**, carrying a cash award of **₹8 Lakh**.
25. The first recipient of the prestigious Bharat Bharti Puraskar was **Mahadevi Varma (1982)**.
26. The highest sports awards in Uttar Pradesh are the **Laxman Award (for Men)** and **Rani Lakshmibai Award (for Women)**, carrying a cash prize of **₹3.11 Lakh**.
27. **Smt. Sarojini Naidu** was the **First Woman Governor** of Uttar Pradesh and in India (1947–1949).
28. **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** was the **First Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954).
29. **Smt. Sucheta Kripalani** was the **First Woman Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh and in India (1963–1967).
30. The first Chief Justice of the High Court of Judicature at Agra (1866) was **Sir Walter Morgan**.

31. The first Indian Chief Justice of the Allahabad High Court after independence was **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik**.
32. The first Lokayukta of Uttar Pradesh was **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** (appointed September 1977).
33. India's first modern vacuum-pan sugar mill was established in **1903 at Pratappur in Deoria district**.
34. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) was the first access-controlled super expressway built in Uttar Pradesh.
35. The world's longest river cruise, **MV Ganga Vilas**, was flagged off from **Varanasi** to Dibrugarh (via Bangladesh) in **January 2023**.
36. **Varanasi** was declared the first **Cultural and Tourism Capital of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)** for 2022–2023.
37. **Kannauj** is known as the **"Attar Nagari"** and the **"Grasse of the East"**.
38. **Firozabad** is famous as **"Suhag Nagari"** and the **"Glass City of India"**.
39. **Moradabad** is internationally renowned as **"Peetal Nagari" (Brass City)**.
40. **Aligarh** is known as **"Taala Nagari" (City of Locks)**.
41. **Bhadohi** is celebrated as the **"Carpet City" (Kaleen Nagari)**.
42. **Kanpur** was historically called the **"Manchester of the East"** and the **"Leather City of the World"**.
43. **Jaunpur** was nicknamed **"Shiraz-e-Hind"** during the Sharqi Sultanate.
44. **Meerut** is known as **"Kranti Nagar"** (1857 spark) and **"Kainchi Nagari" (Scissor City)**.
45. **Pratapgarh** is renowned as **"Aonla Nagari"** (Gooseberry Capital).
46. **Malihabad (Lucknow)** is celebrated as the **"Mango City"** for its world-famous Dasheri mango orchards.
47. **Sonbhadra** is known as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to its pithead mega thermal power plants.
48. Under the **One District One Cuisine (ODOC)** scheme launched in 2026, signature traditional culinary dishes of all 75 districts are branded and promoted.
49. The **Ramnagar Ramlila of Varanasi** (2008) and **Kumbh Mela of Prayagraj** (2017) are inscribed on **UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage List**.
50. North India's first hyperscale data centre, **Yotta D1**, was inaugurated at **Greater Noida** in 2022.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

Chronological Sequence

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1938 ⟶ Official State Seal adopted (Circle containing Bow-and-Arrow, Pair of Fishes / Rohu, and Ganga-Yamuna confluence)
1989 ⟶ Urdu declared the Second Official Language of Uttar Pradesh (UP Official Language Amendment Act, 1989)
2018 ⟶ UP Government notifies January 24 as "Uttar Pradesh Diwas" (UP Day)
2018 ⟶ Launch of ODOP Scheme & UP Defence Industrial Corridor
2021 ⟶ UP Population Policy 2021–2030 released by State Government
2024 ⟶ UP Annual Budget crosses ₹7.36 Lakh Crore milestone
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Table 1: Flagship Government Welfare Schemes & Mission Programmes of Uttar Pradesh

SCHEME / MISSION NAME	LAUNCH YEAR / ADMINISTERING DEPT	TARGET BENEFICIARY GROUP	FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE / KEY PROVISIONS	CORE OBJECTIVES & IMPACT
Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana	**2019** (Women and Child Development Dept)	Girl child from families with annual income $\le ₹3 ext{ Lakh}$ (Max 2 girls per family)	Graded monetary support in **6 stages** (expanded to **₹25,000** total across birth, vaccination, school admissions, and higher education degree enrollment).	• Eliminates female feticide and girl child abandonment. • Promotes institutional deliveries, complete immunization, and higher education retention for girls.
Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana	**February 2021** (Basant Panchami / Social Welfare Dept)	Meritorious and economically underprivileged youth preparing for competitive exams (UPPSC, UPSC, NEET, JEE, NDA, CDS)	Free high-quality classroom coaching, digital study tablets, guest lectures by IAS/IPS officers, and virtual LMS platforms across all 18 divisional headquarters and 75 districts.	• Levels the playing field for rural/poor students lacking funds for private commercial coaching.
Vishwakarma Shram Samman Yojana	**2019** (MSME and Export Promotion Dept)	Traditional village and urban artisans, craftsmen (Barbers, Carpenters, Blacksmiths, Cobblers, Tailors, Potters, Weavers)	6 days of free skill-upgradation training, stipend, and **100% subsidized advanced modern toolkit bags** + bank loan linkages up to ₹10 Lakh without collateral.	• Prevents distress migration. • Modernizes traditional family-based micro-enterprises and integrates them with MSME value chains.
Swami Vivekananda Youth Empowerment Scheme	**December 2021** (IT & Electronics Dept)	Final-year students enrolled in Higher Education, Technical, Medical, Polytechnic, ITI, and Skill Development courses	Free distribution of modern **Smartphones and Tablets** pre-loaded with digital educational content, employment portals, and skill development apps.	• Bridges the digital divide among youth and enables seamless access to online higher education and job opportunities.
Nand Baba Milk Mission	**June 2023** (Dairy Development Dept; Outlay: ₹1,000 Crore)	Dairy farmers, cattle rearers, and rural youth	Groups three key schemes: 1. **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** (subsidies up to 50% for 25-cow dairy units). 2. **Mukhyamantri Swadeshi Gau-Samvardhan Yojana** (incentives for buying Gir, Sahiwal, Tharparkar indigenous cows). 3. **Mukhyamantri Pragatisheel Pashupalak Protsahan Yojana**.	• Enhances milk productivity of indigenous bovine breeds. • Boosts milk processing through village-level Dairy Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs).
Mukhyamantri Yuva Swarojgar Yojana	**2018** (Directorate of Industries)	Educated unemployed youth (18–40 years; minimum High School pass)	Margin money subsidy of 25% (up to ₹6.25 Lakh for industrial projects costing up to ₹25 Lakh; up to ₹2.5 Lakh for service sector up to ₹10 Lakh).	• Promotes local micro-entrepreneurship and self-employment generation in semi-urban and rural areas.
Mission Shakti (Phases 1 to 5)	**October 2020 (Navratri)** (Home, Police & Women Welfare Dept)	Women and girls across all 75 districts	Setting up **Women Helpdesks** in all 1,535+ police stations, Pink Booths, Pink Patrol vehicles, emergency helplines (1090 Women Powerline, 112 ERSS, 181, 1098), and anti-Romeo squads.	• Comprehensive multi-departmental drive ensuring safety, dignity, security, and economic self-reliance (*Suraksha, Samman, Swavalamban*) for women.
Mukhyamantri Khet Talab Yojana	**2018** (Agriculture & Minor Irrigation Dept)	Farmers of drought-prone **Bundelkhand** and Vindhyan region	50% direct subsidy for excavating farm ponds (Khet Talab) on private agricultural land.	• Harvesting rainwater, reviving groundwater aquifers, and providing critical supplemental irrigation.
UP Krishak Durghatna Kalyan Yojana	**2020** (Revenue Dept)	Farmers, agricultural laborers, and bataidars (18–70 years)	Financial compensation of **₹5 Lakh** in case of accidental death or permanent total disability during farming operations.	• Complete social security safety net for agrarian families.

📊 Quick Reference Grid

Table 2: Official State Symbols, Emblems, State Days and Traditional District Nicknames

STATE SYMBOL / ELEMENT	OFFICIAL NAME / LATIN NOMENCLATURE	YEAR OF ADOPTION / DESCRIPTION	CULTURAL, HISTORICAL & ECOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE
State Seal / Emblem	**Circular Seal with Bow-Arrow, Twin Fish and Tri-stream Confluence**	Adopted in **1938**	• **Bow and Arrow (*Dhanush-Baan*)**: Symbolizes Lord Rama and the valorous heritage of Awadh/Ayodhya. • **Pair of Fish (*Matsya*)**: Symbolizes the Nawabs of Awadh (emblem of royal sovereignty derived from the Mughal *Mahi-o-Maratib*). • **Three Wave Lines**: Symbolizes the holy confluence of **Ganga, Yamuna, and mythical Saraswati** at Prayagraj.
State Animal	**Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*)	Declared official State Animal	• Endemic to the moist alluvial grassland and swamp ecosystem of the Terai belt; protected core population thrives in **Dudhwa National Park**.
State Bird	**Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*)	Declared official State Bird	• World's tallest flying bird; revered as a lifelong symbol of marital fidelity and devotion. Over 70% of India's Sarus population lives in the wetlands of South-Western and Central UP (Mainpuri, Etawah, Auraiya).
State Tree	**Ashoka (Sita Ashoka)** (*Saraca asoca*)	Declared official State Tree	• Sacred indigenous evergreen rainforest tree associated with the Ramayana (Ashoka Vatika); famous for fragrant orange-yellow blossoms.
State Flower	**Palash / Dhak / Tesu** (*Butea monosperma*)	Declared on **4 January 2011** (replaced Brahmakamal)	• Known as the "Flame of the Forest"; blooms with vibrant fiery red-orange flowers during spring across the Vindhyan and Bundelkhand scrublands.
State Aquatic Animal	**Gangetic River Dolphin (Susu)** (*Platanista gangetica*)	Re-affirmed in **October 2023**	• National and State aquatic animal; apex biological indicator of freshwater health in the Ganga, Yamuna, Chambal, and Geruwa rivers.
State Day (UP Diwas)	**24 January**	Notification dated 24 Jan 1950 (Celebrated since **2018**)	• Commemorates the historic signing of the United Provinces (Alteration of Name) Order, 1950, renaming the state as **Uttar Pradesh**.

Master Table of Traditional District Nicknames & Epithets of Uttar Pradesh

DISTRICT / CITY	TRADITIONAL NICKNAME / CULTURAL EPITHET	DISTRICT / CITY	TRADITIONAL NICKNAME / CULTURAL EPITHET
Varanasi	*City of Light (Kashi), City of Ghats, Cultural Capital of India, Mokshapuri*	**Prayagraj**	*Sangam Nagari, Tirthraj, Kumbh Nagari, Amrud Nagari (City of Guavas)*
Kannauj	*Attar Nagari (Perfume City), Grasse of the East, Mahodaya Shri, Kanyakubja*	**Kanpur**	*Manchester of the East, Leather City of the World, Industrial Capital of UP*
Moradabad	*Peetal Nagari (Brass City)*	**Firozabad**	*Suhag Nagari, Glass City of India, Chudi Nagari*
Aligarh	*Taala Nagari (City of Locks), Harigarh*	**Bhadohi**	*Carpet City (Kaleen Nagari)*
Lucknow	*City of Nawabs, City of Gardens (Baghon ka Shahar), Shiraz-e-Awadh*	**Jaunpur**	*Shiraz-e-Hind* (for medieval art and learning)
Mathura	*Krishna Nagari, Peda Nagari, City of Temples*	**Ayodhya**	*Ram Nagari, Saket, City of Temples*
Agra	*Taj Nagari, Petha Nagari, Leather Footwear Capital*	**Bareilly**	*Surma Nagari, Jhumka City, Bans Bareilly*
Meerut	*Kranti Nagar (City of Revolution), Sports City of India, Scissor City (Kainchi Nagari)*	**Saharanpur**	*Woodcraft City (Nakkashi Nagari)*
Pratapgarh	*Aonla Nagari (Gooseberry Capital)*	**Malihabad (Lucknow)**	*Mango City (Aam Nagari)*
Sonbhadra	*Energy Capital of India, Switzerland of Uttar Pradesh*	**Hathras**	*Hing Nagari (Asafoetida City), Mahamaya Nagar*

Table 3: State Honors, Literary Awards, Sports Honors & Institutional Firsts

AWARD / HONOR / FIRST	CONFERRED BY / ASSOCIATED FIELD	CASH PRIZE / DISTINCTION	HISTORIC FIRSTS & NOTABLE LAUREATES
UP Gaurav Samman	Government of Uttar Pradesh (Replaced Yash Bharti)	**₹11 Lakh** + Citation	• Highest civil honor of the Government of UP; awarded annually to eminent achievers across science, agriculture, arts, and entrepreneurship.
Bharat Bharti Puraskar	**Uttar Pradesh Hindi Sansthan (Lucknow)**	**₹8 Lakh** (Highest Hindi literary award of UP)	• Conferred for lifetime contribution to Hindi literature. • First recipient: **Mahadevi Varma** (1982). Other titans: Dharmavir Bharati, Vidya Niwas Mishra.
Laxman Award & Rani Lakshmibai Award	**UP Sports Department**	**₹3.11 Lakh** (enhanced) + Bronze Statue	• **Laxman Award**: Highest sports award of UP for outstanding male sportspersons. • **Rani Lakshmibai Award**: Highest sports award of UP for outstanding female sportspersons.
First Governor of UP	Constitutional Executive	Smt. **Sarojini Naidu**	• Served 15 August 1947 to 2 March 1949 (First woman Governor of an Indian State).
First Chief Minister of UP	Democratic Executive	Pandit **Govind Ballabh Pant**	• Served 26 January 1950 to 27 December 1954 (Premier of United Provinces since 1937).
First Woman Chief Minister	Democratic Executive	Smt. **Sucheta Kripalani**	• Served October 1963 to March 1967 (First woman Chief Minister in India).
First Chief Justice of High Court	Judiciary (Agra/Allahabad)	**Sir Walter Morgan** (1866)	• First Indian CJ post-independence: **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik** (1947).
First Lokayukta of UP	Anti-Corruption Ombudsman	**Justice Vishwambhar Dayal**	• Appointed in September 1977 under the UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act, 1975.
First Modern Sugar Mill	Industrial History	**Pratappur (Deoria)**	• Established in **1903**, pioneering the modern vacuum-pan sugar industry in India.
First Access-Controlled Expressway	Road Infrastructure	**Yamuna Expressway**	• 165-km 6-lane expressway connecting Greater Noida to Agra (operational 2012).
First UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage from UP	Global Cultural Recognition	**Ramnagar Ramlila** (2008) & **Kumbh Mela** (2017)	• Inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

- **Official State Symbols of Uttar Pradesh**:
- **State Animal**: **Barasingha / Swamp Deer** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*)
- **State Bird**: **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*) — tallest flying bird!
- **State Flower**: **Palash / Tesu / Flame of the Forest** (*Butea monosperma*)
- **State Tree**: **Ashoka** (*Saraca asoca*)
- **State Aquatic Animal**: **Gangetic Dolphin** (Susu — *Platanista gangetica*)
- **State Fish**: **Chitala** (*Chitala chitala*)
- **Traditional District Nicknames**:
- Kannauj: **Attar Nagari / Perfume City of India**
- Firozabad: **Suhag Nagari / Glass City**
- Moradabad: **Peetal Nagari / Brass City**
- Kanpur: **Manchester of the East / Leather City**
- Prayagraj: **Sangam Nagari / Kumbh Nagari / City of Prime Ministers**
- Varanasi: **City of Ghats / Cultural Capital of India / Moksha Nagari**
- Malihabad (Lucknow): **Mango Capital (Dussehri)**.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. As per ODOP of Uttar Pradesh, Moonj products are associated with: A. Amethi & Sultanpur B. Only Sant Kabir Nagar C. Only Varanasi D. Only Meerut

▶ Details

Q5. The 'Kashi Vishwanath Corridor' in Varanasi was inaugurated in which year? A. 2019 B. 2020 C. 2021 D. 2022

▶ Show answer

Q6. The 'UP Defence Industrial Corridor' has been set up along which two major route alignments? A. Lucknow-Agra and Jhansi-Aligarh B. Varanasi-Kanpur and Meerut-Agra C. Allahabad-Lucknow and Gorakhpur-Noida D. Mathura-Aligarh and Jhansi-Kanpur

▶ Show answer

Q7. Which city in Uttar Pradesh has been selected for the development of the Jewar International Airport (Noida International Airport)? A. Lucknow B. Gautam Buddha Nagar (Jewar) C. Ghaziabad D. Meerut

▶ Show answer

Q8. 'Global Investors Summit (GIS) 2023' held in Lucknow saw MoU investments totalling approximately: A. Rs 10 lakh crore B. Rs 20 lakh crore C. Rs 33.5 lakh crore D. Rs 50 lakh crore

▶ Show answer

Q9. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Uttar Pradesh Diwas (UP Day) is officially celebrated every year on 24 January. B. Both statements are true and explain the phenomenon C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. It was established during the First Five-Year Plan period

▶ Show answer

Q10. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Palash applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Palash was officially declared as the State Flower on 4 January 2011, replacing Brahmakamal. C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria

▶ Show answer

Q11. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Kamdhenu applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Recognized by UNESCO under World Heritage natural criteria C. Kamdhenu Dairy Yojana is an older standalone scheme and is NOT a component of the current Nand Baba Milk Mission. D. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India

▶ Show answer

Q12. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Mission applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Enacted under Article 356 of the Constitution of India C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Mission Shakti was launched during Shardiya Navratri in October 2020 to ensure women's security, dignity, and self-reliance.

▶ Show answer

Q13. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Nivesh Mitra is Uttar Pradesh's flagship digital single-window portal for industrial clearances and investor facilitation. B. Reported by the Law Commission in its 214th consultation paper C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Amended by the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act

▶ Show answer

Q14. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Smt. applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Smt. Sarojini Naidu was the First Woman Governor of Uttar Pradesh and in India (1947–1949). C. None of the above statements are correct according to official Commission keys. D. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys

▶ Show answer

Q15. in UP Special, consider the following statement:

Which of the following is correct regarding this topic?

A. Contrary to standard doctrine, Pandit applies only to union territories and not state jurisdictions. B. Excavated primarily in the Belan and Son River valleys C. Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant was the First Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954). D. Classified under Schedule VII List II (State List)

▶ Show answer